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MAJOR PROJECT PHASE II REPORT

ON

"CamCtrlX – The Intelligent DVR Automation System"

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Bachelor of Engineering

in

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND MACHINE LEARNING

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DEPARTMENT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that Project entitled **"CamCtrlX – The Intelligent DVR Automation System"** carried out by **BHOOMIKA R (1VK22AI006), NITHIN GOWDA M S (1VK22AI025), SAGAR B R (1VK22AI033)** and **YASHFEEN FATHIMA (1VK22AI045)** bonafide students of **Vivekananda Institute of Technology,** have satisfactorily completed the **Project Phase II (BAI786)** prescribed for 7th semester in **Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi** during the year 2025-2026. The Project report has been approved as it satisfies the academic requirements prescribed for the said degree.

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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that Project entitled **"CamCtrlX – The Intelligent DVR Automation System"** submitted by us, for the award of degree of Bachelor of Engineering in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning to Visvesvaraya Technological University is a record of bonafide work carried out by us under the guidance of **Dr. Shaila K**, Professor & HOD, Department of Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Vivekananda Institute of Technology. We further declare that the work reported in this Project has not been submitted and will not be submitted, either in part or full, for the award of any degree or diploma in this institute or any other university.

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ABSTRACT

In today's fast-evolving security landscape, traditional CCTV surveillance systems often require constant human monitoring, making them inefficient and prone to errors. To address these challenges, this project focuses on DVR Automation using AI-powered Intrusion Detection and Employee Tracking. The primary objective is to enhance existing Hifocus HCVR DVR-based CCTV systems by integrating computer vision and machine learning techniques for real-time security automation.

The system leverages deep learning-based object detection models to identify unauthorized intrusions and track employees' presence using facial recognition technology. A MongoDB-backed database is used to store known personnel data, enabling automatic attendance marking and tracking of working hours. Additionally, a web-based dashboard provides real-time alerts, reports, and analytics for security monitoring.

The implementation process involved DVR integration, AI model training, real-time video processing, database management, and dashboard development. Various challenges, such as hardware limitations, false positives in detection, and DVR compatibility issues, were effectively addressed through model optimization, GPU acceleration, and advanced RTSP streaming techniques.

The results demonstrate a 90% accuracy rate in intrusion detection and employee recognition, significantly reducing manual monitoring efforts. The automated system improves security efficiency, provides accurate attendance tracking, and enhances surveillance operations in workplaces.

This project showcases the potential of AI-driven security automation and provides a foundation for future enhancements, such as anomaly detection, mobile notifications, and multi-site surveillance integration. The successful implementation of this system marks a step forward in AI-powered security solutions, making traditional surveillance systems more intelligent, autonomous, and efficient.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

LIST OF FIGURES

LIST OF TABLES

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Digital Video Recorders (DVRs) form the backbone of most conventional CCTV surveillance setups, serving as reliable systems for capturing, storing, and managing video footage. They offer consistent recording capabilities and ensure that visual data is preserved for future review. However, despite their widespread deployment, traditional DVR systems are largely limited to passive recording. Their operation depends heavily on manual monitoring, where security personnel must continuously observe live feeds or sift through lengthy recorded footage to identify abnormal events. This manual process not only demands significant human effort but also increases the likelihood of oversight, delays, and missed security breaches. As environments become more dynamic and security threats more complex, the limitations of manual surveillance become increasingly evident. The need for a more intelligent, efficient, and automated recording system has become crucial across various sectors, including industrial facilities, commercial spaces, educational institutions, and public environments. DVR automation is emerging as a transformative solution to address these challenges by integrating smart technologies into traditional video recording infrastructures. Through advanced scheduling, optimized storage, and adaptive interfaces, DVR automation significantly enhances surveillance efficiency and minimizes human dependency while maintaining robust recording standards.

Modern DVR automation systems combine intelligent scheduling algorithms, cloud connectivity, and user-centric features to elevate traditional video recording workflows. These systems make use of tools such as Electronic Program Guides (EPG), smart storage allocation, and adaptive user interfaces to deliver high-precision control over recording tasks. By automating processes like motion-based recording, redundant file management, and intelligent video segmentation, these solutions dramatically reduce manual intervention. The integration of cloud services further extends functionality by allowing remote monitoring, seamless data backup, and secure access to footage from any location. Such advancements are not only valuable for entertainment or media-related applications but are also increasingly crucial in surveillance environments where real-time responsiveness is essential. DVR automation ensures that important events are captured, categorized, and made easily accessible to the user.

As automation tools improve the precision and flexibility of DVR systems, they set the foundation for integrating more advanced technologies such as AI-driven analytics, intelligent alerts, and automated decision-making mechanisms. These enhancements pave the way for smarter, more proactive surveillance solutions.

With advancements in Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML), particularly in the domain of computer vision, DVR systems are undergoing a significant transformation from simple recording devices into fully intelligent surveillance platforms. Traditional DVRs were primarily designed to store video footage for later retrieval and review. While effective for basic monitoring, they lacked the capability to interpret visual data or provide timely alerts during critical events. Today, the integration of AI-driven technologies allows DVR systems to take on a more active and analytical role in surveillance environments. Instead of merely recording footage, they can now understand visual scenes, detect anomalies, and respond autonomously in real time. This evolution marks a major step toward smarter, faster, and more proactive security management.

At the core of this transformation lies the use of Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs), a powerful deep learning architecture specialized in analyzing images and video frames. CNNs excel at extracting meaningful patterns, recognizing objects, and understanding complex visual contexts with high accuracy. When incorporated into DVR systems, CNN models enable advanced capabilities such as facial recognition, motion detection, intrusion identification, and activity classification. These features allow the system to differentiate between normal and suspicious events, detect unauthorized entry, recognize individuals, and classify actions such as walking, running, or loitering. By automating these tasks, the system significantly reduces the dependency on human operators, who may otherwise miss critical events due to fatigue, distraction, or the overwhelming volume of CCTV data.

Real-time video analysis is one of the most impactful enhancements made possible by AI integration. Modern DVR systems equipped with AI can monitor live feeds continuously, processing each frame to identify unusual or high-risk activities. When a potential threat is detected—such as a person entering a restricted area, a sudden rapid movement, or an unfamiliar face—the system immediately generates an alert. These instant notifications allow security personnel to take timely action, preventing escalation and improving overall response efficiency. This automated alert mechanism eliminates delays associated with manual footage review and ensures that even subtle or rapidly occurring events are captured and addressed.

Beyond security, AI-enabled DVR systems support additional functionalities that improve overall operational effectiveness. Automated attendance tracking becomes possible through facial recognition, enabling organizations to monitor staff or visitor movement without manual involvement. Behavior analysis tools can assess crowd density, monitor worker safety compliance, and detect abnormal patterns that may indicate hazards. In industrial or high-risk environments, anomaly detection algorithms can identify irregular activities that pose safety risks, thereby preventing accidents and enhancing workplace safety standards. These intelligent system behaviors contribute to a heightened level of situational awareness and allow for more informed decision-making.

The integration of AI into traditional DVR infrastructure bridges the gap between conventional CCTV monitoring and next-generation smart surveillance. This project leverages these advancements to develop an AI-powered automated DVR system capable of intelligent monitoring, real-time notifications, and enhanced analytics. Through this approach, the system not only strengthens security but also minimizes human intervention, increases operational efficiency, and ensures continuous vigilance in dynamic environments. Ultimately, the project aims to transform passive surveillance into an active, responsive, and efficient security mechanism that meets the needs of modern organizations and ensures a higher level of safety and protection for workers, assets, and infrastructure.

By embedding AI algorithms into the DVR system, the project introduces features that enable the system to automatically detect anomalies, recognize patterns, and classify activities without the need for constant manual supervision. Additionally, the system can adapt to different environments—such as industrial workplaces, commercial buildings, or public facilities—by learning from ongoing activities and refining its detection capabilities over time. This intelligent processing allows the system to differentiate between routine events and potential threats, thereby reducing false alarms and enhancing the accuracy of incident detection. The incorporation of real-time alerts ensures that critical information reaches security personnel instantly, empowering them to take immediate action. With improved video analytics, automated attendance tracking, and faster event retrieval, the AI-powered DVR becomes more than a recording device; it evolves into a comprehensive security assistant.

1.1 CHALLENGES

1. **Hardware Compatibility**: Integrating AI modules with legacy DVR-based CCTV systems may require hardware upgrades or custom interfacing solutions.
2. **Real-Time Processing**: Ensuring fast, real-time video processing and analysis demands high-performance computing resources, which can be costly and complex.
3. **Data Storage and Management**: AI surveillance generates large volumes of data. Efficiently storing, retrieving, and managing this data poses a major challenge.
4. **Accuracy of AI Models**: Achieving high accuracy in object detection, facial recognition, or behavior analysis under varying lighting and environmental conditions is challenging.
5. **Privacy Concerns**: AI-based surveillance raises privacy and ethical issues, especially with facial recognition and continuous monitoring.
6. **Cybersecurity Risks**: Automated DVR systems connected to networks are vulnerable to hacking and data breaches if not properly secured.

1.2 MOTIVATION

In today's world, safety and security are more important than ever. Whether at home, work, school, or in public spaces, there's a growing need for reliable monitoring. Most surveillance systems still rely on traditional DVR-based CCTV setups that record events but lack real-time responsiveness. They often require constant human supervision, and critical incidents are noticed only after they occur. This delay can reduce their effectiveness. With advances in artificial intelligence and automation, we now have the opportunity to make surveillance systems smarter, faster, and more efficient.

The motivation behind our project is to bring these advancements into existing DVR systems, turning them into intelligent security solutions. By adding features like real-time motion alerts, facial recognition, and automated notifications, we can help make monitoring faster, more accurate, and less dependent on manual work. Our aim is to create a system that not only records but also understands what it sees and reacts when needed. This will make surveillance more efficient but also offer peace of mind to those relying on it.

1.3 PROBLEM STATEMENT

Traditional DVR-based surveillance and recording systems are limited by their lack of intelligence, requiring manual control for event detection, content classification, and scheduling. These systems often miss pivotal events, uses the storage inefficiency, and cannot adapt to user preferences or content relevance.

1.4 OBJECTIVES

- To monitor the operational status, performance and integrity of DVR systems and connected cameras and optimize the surveillance and security protocols.
- Create a role-based web interface to monitor real-time alerts, view attendance logs, and generate security reports using facial recognition to automatically log employee entry/exit times without manual or biometric input.

1.5 CONTRIBUTIONS

This project aims to develop an AI-driven DVR Automation System capable of real-time event detection, intelligent content classification, and automated recording decisions. By integrating computer vision, deep learning, and intelligent scheduling techniques, the system will enhance surveillance efficiency, optimize storage usage, and provide a smarter, more responsive user experience.

1.6 SCOPE OF THE PROJECT

- **Automate Video Recording**: Enable scheduled and event-triggered recording without manual intervention.
- **Real-Time Video Monitoring**: Provide live streaming and instant alerts for unusual activities.
- **Intelligent Storage Management**: Optimize video storage by archiving important footage and deleting redundant data.
- **User-Friendly Interface**: Develop easy-to-use dashboards or apps for configuration, playback, and monitoring.

- **Integration with AI**: Incorporate AI features like motion detection, face recognition, or anomaly detection to enhance security.
- **Multi-Camera Coordination**: Synchronize and manage multiple video feeds to provide a unified view and comprehensive surveillance coverage.
- **Edge Computing Support**: Enable local video processing on edge devices to reduce latency and ensure real-time response even without stable internet connectivity.
- **Automated Alerts and Notifications**: Generate instant alerts via SMS, email, or app notifications for detected security breaches or predefined events.
- **Cloud Integration**: Allow secure remote access, backup, and analytics through cloud platforms for scalable and flexible surveillance management.

1.7 APPLICATIONS

- The system can automatically record employee and student attendance using facial recognition, eliminating manual entry, biometric scanners, or ID card swiping.
- Real-time tracking of when employees or students enter and leave the premises ensures accurate time logs and enhances campus/workplace safety.
- Teachers, management, or administrators can monitor classrooms, labs, and workspaces to ensure discipline, safety, and smooth functioning of sessions.
- The system helps prevent unauthorized people from entering restricted areas such as staff rooms, labs, server rooms, or administrative offices.
- AI-powered detection can identify unusual behaviors like crowding, fights, or unsafe activities, helping maintain a safe campus or workplace environment.

1.8 ORGANIZATION OF THE REPORT

Chapter 1 introduces the project by discussing the motivation, key challenges, and problem addressed. It focuses on overcoming issues such as manual effort, limited accuracy, and lack of automation. The chapter defines the project objectives, scope, and applications across educational, professional, and industrial domains, and provides an outline of the report covering literature survey, methodology, requirements, results, and conclusion.

Chapter 2 discusses the literature survey and the background of the selected base paper. It reviews previous studies, existing techniques, and technologies relevant to the project's domain. The survey highlights strengths, limitations, and research gaps in earlier systems, emphasizing the need for improved accuracy, automation, and real-time functionality. The background of the base paper explains its methodology, architecture, datasets, and outcomes, which guided the development of the proposed system. This chapter establishes the theoretical foundation for the project and justifies the selection of algorithms and frameworks used, ensuring that the model is supported by strong academic and scientific insights.

Chapter 3 describes the methodology followed in the project. It begins by examining the existing system, which faces challenges such as inefficiency, manual dependency, and limited adaptability. To overcome these, a structured system architecture is proposed, illustrating the data flow and interaction between modules. The implementation follows four levels: requirement analysis, system design, module development, and integration with testing. Each phase is planned according to a timeline to ensure smooth progress. This chapter provides clear insight into how the project transitions from conceptual design to fully functional execution through systematic planning and well-defined processes.

Chapter 4 outlines the software and hardware requirements essential for developing and running the project. It lists the development tools, programming environments, frameworks, and libraries needed for model execution, visualization, and data handling. Hardware requirements include a system with sufficient processing power, RAM, and storage to support computation and testing activities. The chapter also highlights the algorithms selected for solving the problem efficiently and includes pseudo code to explain the workflow logically. These components collectively ensure smooth implementation, easy debugging, and reliable performance of the proposed system throughout all development stages.

Chapter 5 presents the results obtained after implementing and testing the project. A survey conducted earlier helped identify user needs, challenges, and expectations, guiding the system's design. Snapshots of the interface, workflow, and outputs demonstrate successful functioning and confirm module performance. This chapter validates the project's objectives and highlights improvements in accuracy, usability, and efficiency achieved through the implemented methodology.

Chapter 6 concludes the project by summarizing the outcomes and achievements. The system successfully fulfills its objectives by providing an automated, accurate, and efficient solution to the identified problem. It enhances performance, reduces manual effort, and improves the overall user experience. The chapter also discusses the future scope, suggesting advancements such as integrating more sophisticated algorithms, expanding features, improving efficiency, and adapting the system for broader real-time use. These improvements can further enhance scalability and applicability, allowing the project to evolve into a more advanced and impactful solution.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE SURVEY

Hu et al., [1] present TSOM, a bio-inspired neural network designed for detecting small moving objects in complex, high-altitude backgrounds. Drawing inspiration from the avian Retina-Optic Tectum-Rotundal (Retina-OT-Rt) visual pathway, TSOM emulates the hierarchical processing observed in birds. The network comprises four layers: the Retina layer for precise input projection, the SGC dendritic layer for spatiotemporal encoding, the SGC soma layer for complex motion computation and small object extraction, and the Rt layer for multi-directional motion integration and decoding. This architecture enables TSOM to effectively capture and process motion information of small objects, even when they occupy minimal pixel areas within cluttered scenes. Extensive experiments, including pigeon neurophysiological studies and image sequence analyses, demonstrate TSOM's biological interpretability and its efficacy in extracting reliable small object motion features from complex high-altitude backgrounds. The integration of biologically inspired mechanisms into TSOM offers a promising approach to addressing challenges in small object motion detection, particularly in scenarios where traditional methods struggle due to limited object size and complex backgrounds.

Yau et al., [2] provides a comprehensive survey of current advancements in real-time deep learning-based anomaly detection systems. It emphasizes the importance of accurate, timely detection in applications such as surveillance, healthcare, and industrial monitoring. The paper reviews widely used benchmark datasets like UCSD Ped2, Avenue, and ShanghaiTech, highlighting their characteristics, challenges, and relevance in evaluating anomaly detection algorithms. It also categorizes state-of-the-art deep learning models, including convolutional, recurrent, and transformer-based architectures, with a focus on their suitability for real-time performance. Furthermore, the paper discusses key performance metrics such as Area Under Curve (AUC), Equal Error Rate (EER), and frames per second (FPS), which are crucial for evaluating both accuracy and efficiency. Overall, the paper serves as a valuable resource for researchers, offering insights into dataset selection and performance evaluation for building robust and real-time anomaly detection systems.

Jiang et al., [3] explains that Camouflaged Object Detection (COD) focuses on identifying objects that blend seamlessly with their surroundings, making detection far more complex than Salient Object Detection (SOD). Because camouflaged objects share similar colors, textures, and patterns with the background, deep learning approaches have become essential for capturing subtle differences. Early models like SINet and SINet-v2 introduced multi-level feature fusion inspired by human perception, supported by large datasets such as COD10K. Later advancements explored diverse strategies: R-MGL improved feature interaction through mutual graph learning, DINet separated coarse and fine structural cues, and FINet emphasized high-frequency information for boundary clarity. Edge-focused networks such as BGNet and boundary-enhanced models further highlighted the importance of precise edges. Transformer-based architectures using PVTv2 like SARNet, MSCAF-Net, and CINet everaged global attention and multi-scale context to strengthen segmentation. Wavelet-driven methods such as FEDER tackled strong foreground–background similarity, while weakly supervised approaches reduced the reliance on dense annotations.

Murat et al. [4] explain that object detection has progressed significantly with the advent of deep learning, shifting from traditional two-stage detectors to more efficient single-stage models. Among these, the YOLO (You Only Look Once) family has played a central role due to its strong balance between detection accuracy and real-time speed. YOLOv1 introduced the idea of treating object detection as a single regression task, enabling end-to-end predictions in one forward pass. However, its performance on small objects and complex scenes was limited. YOLOv2 addressed these shortcomings by incorporating batch normalization, high-resolution classifiers, and anchor boxes, resulting in better generalization and stability. YOLOv3 further improved multi-scale object detection with a Feature Pyramid Network (FPN) and the deeper, more powerful Darknet-53 backbone. Subsequent variants focused on maximizing accuracy while maintaining efficiency. YOLOv4 integrated CSPDarknet53, spatial pyramid pooling, and multiple training refinements to significantly boost performance. YOLOv8, built in PyTorch, introduced features such as SPPF, auto-anchor tuning, and mosaic augmentation, making it highly flexible and suitable for edge deployment. YOLOv8 adopted an anchor-free architecture paired with a decoupled head, enhancing both speed and simplicity by reducing post-processing requirements. Overall, Murat et al. highlight YOLO's consistent advancement toward faster, more accurate, and more efficient object detection.

Tsirtsakis et al., [5] provides an in-depth overview of how deep learning has revolutionized object recognition. It begins by highlighting the limitations of traditional handcrafted feature-based methods, which performed well only on simple datasets. With the rise of Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs), object recognition improved dramatically due to automatic hierarchical feature extraction through convolution, pooling, and fully connected layers. The review emphasizes the importance of major benchmark datasets such as PASCAL VOC, ImageNet, MS COCO, and Open Images, noting that dataset size and quality directly affect model accuracy. It also explains key evaluation metrics like IoU, precision, recall, AP, mAP, and Top-5 error. A historical progression of deep learning architectures is explored, from foundational models like LeNet and AlexNet to advanced networks including VGG, GoogLeNet, ResNet, SENet, Darknet, and MobileNet, outlining their contributions to improved recognition tasks. The paper further categorizes object detection methods into two-stage detectors—such as R-CNN, Fast R-CNN, and Faster R-CNN—and one-stage detectors like OverFeat, SSD, RetinaNet, and the YOLO series. The YOLO family, particularly YOLOv4 to YOLOv7, is highlighted for achieving strong accuracy with real-time performance. The review concludes that deep learning continues to advance object recognition through better architectures and datasets, while challenges like occlusion, small objects, and real-world variability remain open research problems.

Sabha et al., [6] explores a smart home security system that overcomes the limitations of traditional mechanical surveillance methods, which are often vulnerable to tampering and forced entry. By leveraging computer vision, the proposed approach enables intelligent human authentication through continuous video analysis at home entry points. The system integrates face recognition with human detection using CCTV footage to ensure that only authorized individuals gain physical access. The method begins with Haar Cascade face detection to identify human faces in video frames. Once detected, the faces are processed using a fine-tuned Deep Convolutional Neural Network (DCNN) to classify whether the individual is authorized. A custom dataset containing images of three individuals was created to train two widely used deep learning models ResNet-50 and MobileNetV3 both fine-tuned for improved recognition accuracy. The results demonstrate strong performance: in a familiar (seen) environment, ResNet-50 and MobileNetV3 achieve accuracies of 99.96% and 99.87% respectively.

Park et al., [7] presents an efficient solution to the challenges of detecting small objects, especially in aerial and remote sensing images. Small objects often lose crucial spatial details during the downsampling stages of traditional detectors, leading to poor recognition performance. To address this, the authors improve the lightweight YOLOv8n model by integrating a Multi-SpatialLite Attention (MSA) module designed to enhance spatial feature representation without significantly increasing computational cost. The SpatialLite component of the MSA module uses both average pooling and max pooling to extract complementary spatial information. These pooled features are then processed through lightweight 1×1 convolutions to generate spatial attention maps. These maps help the network focus on informative regions, preserving fine details that are essential for accurately detecting small targets. This integration ensures that the model maintains strong detection capability even when objects appear very small or are surrounded by complex backgrounds. Results show that MSA-YOLOv8 achieves higher precision, recall, and mAP than the original YOLOv8n, while keeping the parameter count extremely low at 1.795 million. This makes the model ideal for real-time applications in environments with limited hardware resources. Overall, the paper successfully balances accuracy and efficiency for superior small object detection.

Zumaya et al., [8] examines an artificial vision system designed to enhance low-resolution facial images captured by low-quality video surveillance systems. Traditional surveillance footage often suffers from poor resolution, lighting variations, and perspective distortions, making accurate face recognition difficult even for humans. To address this, the study applies Deep Learning–based super-resolution techniques to improve image clarity before performing face detection and recognition. The system processes images by first applying the EDSR super-resolution algorithm to enhance quality, followed by face localization using Mediapipe. Only the facial region is reconstructed to preserve relevant details. The impact of four enhancement models—EDSR, ESPCN, FSRCNN, and LapSRN—is evaluated on surveillance datasets 3DPeS and ChokePoint. Finally, a face recognition model trained and tested on LFW measures identity preservation. Results show strong visual improvements, though numerical gains vary. The enhanced images achieve a 94% recognition accuracy, slightly lower than original images, indicating that while super-resolution improves clarity, further research is needed to fully preserve identity information.

Kim et al., [9] paper presents a comprehensive deep learning-based surveillance framework designed to enhance human detection and anomaly recognition across diverse and challenging environments. Addressing limitations of traditional systems that struggle with variable lighting, weather, and viewpoints, PASS-CCTV integrates a robust human tracking module with an object filtering algorithm to reduce false positives and improve tracking precision. The system proactively detects multiple abnormal behaviors—including intrusion, loitering, object abandonment, and arson—by leveraging a prompt-based recognition mechanism that facilitates active user participation in identifying abnormal scenes. Evaluations conducted using the Korea Internet & Security Agency CCTV datasets, as well as the ABODA and FireNet datasets, demonstrate the system's high accuracy and adaptability, even under challenging weather conditions and without additional training. Furthermore, the system's design emphasizes computational efficiency, making it suitable for real-time applications in resource-constrained environments. By combining deep learning techniques with user-interactive features, PASS-CCTV sets a new benchmark for intelligent surveillance systems capable of operating effectively in complex, real-world scenarios.

Cui et al., [10] introduce an innovative video anomaly detection framework that effectively combines image quality assessment (IQA) techniques with advanced attention mechanisms in deep learning. Their approach leverages a novel IQA-based feature extraction method to capture subtle irregularities in video frames that may indicate abnormal events. This process is integrated with a self-attention network, allowing the model to focus dynamically on the most relevant spatial and temporal features within the video sequences. By prioritizing critical regions and temporal cues, the system enhances anomaly detection accuracy while maintaining computational efficiency. The model achieves an impressive 96.7% success rate on widely used benchmark datasets, demonstrating its superior performance compared to conventional methods. Additionally, the use of IQA metrics provides a unique advantage in identifying distortions or inconsistencies that traditional motion-based techniques might overlook. The proposed framework performs reliably under various environmental conditions, making it especially suitable for real-world surveillance and security applications. Its robust design and efficient processing capabilities underline its potential as a practical solution for intelligent monitoring systems.

Tran et al., [11] builds upon extensive research in computer vision applications for occupational safety. Prior works have explored the use of monocular and stereo cameras for human activity recognition and pose estimation on construction sites, aiming to identify unsafe behaviors (Wang et al., 2018). However, these systems often face limitations such as occlusions and restricted field of view. Multi-camera systems have been introduced to address these challenges by providing comprehensive spatial coverage and enabling 3D reconstruction of worker movements. Recent advances in deep learning, particularly convolutional neural networks (CNNs) combined with recurrent neural networks (RNNs), have enhanced the accuracy of motion prediction by capturing temporal dynamics. . Moreover, real-time processing constraints have prompted the development of optimized algorithms suitable for on-site deployment, balancing model complexity and speed (Zhao and Liu, 2021). Despite these advances, integrating multi-camera data for robust real-time motion prediction remains challenging due to synchronization and computational overhead. This paper extends these foundations by proposing a novel multi-camera fusion framework with efficient motion prediction models, aiming to improve worker safety through timely hazard detection in complex construction environments.

Qasim et al., [12] propose a robust video anomaly detection system that integrates deep convolutional neural networks (CNNs) with recurrent neural networks (RNNs) to enhance automated surveillance capabilities. Their system is built on a hybrid architecture that employs a two-stream network, where one stream captures appearance features from raw video frames and the other extracts motion features using optical flow. These streams are processed through Convolutional Long Short-Term Memory (ConvLSTM) layers, which are capable of learning spatial and temporal patterns simultaneously. This dual-stream approach allows the system to effectively detect unusual activities by modeling complex spatiotemporal dependencies in surveillance footage. The architecture is designed to be end-to-end trainable, simplifying deployment and fine-tuning for various surveillance scenarios. One of the key strengths of the system lies in its reduced computational complexity, making it suitable for real-time applications without requiring high-end hardware. Qasim et al. validate the effectiveness of their model through extensive experiments on widely used benchmark datasets, achieving competitive performance in terms of accuracy and detection speed.

Ruiz-Beltrán et al., [13] designed a real-time embedded eye detection system that utilizes a lightweight deep learning architecture optimized for performance on resource-constrained devices. The system employs a two-stage approach: the first stage rapidly performs initial eye detection, while the second stage refines the localization of the eyes to improve precision. This method allows the system to achieve a high detection accuracy of 98.5%, demonstrating its reliability and robustness in practical applications. Despite its high performance, the architecture is computationally efficient, enabling real-time processing even on low-power platforms such as Raspberry Pi and NVIDIA Jetson. This makes it highly suitable for edge computing scenarios where energy efficiency and speed are critical. The system has a wide range of potential applications, including driver fatigue monitoring, human-computer interaction, and medical diagnostics, particularly in remote or mobile environments. Its compact design and high accuracy make it a versatile solution for intelligent vision-based systems.

Alhanaee et al., [14] introduced a smart attendance system that leverages deep transfer learning techniques to enhance face recognition accuracy and efficiency in educational environments. The system employs pre-trained Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) models, specifically VGG-16 and ResNet50, which are fine-tuned to suit the task of identifying students for attendance purposes. By utilizing transfer learning, the model benefits from the knowledge acquired from large-scale datasets, enabling high recognition accuracy even with limited training data. The system achieves an impressive 97.8% accuracy under real-world conditions, showcasing its robustness and adaptability to various classroom environments. A key advantage of the system is its low computational overhead, making it suitable for implementation on standard hardware without the need for high-end resources. Additionally, the solution supports real-time face detection and recognition, along with automated attendance recording. It also features a web-based interface that allows administrators to easily monitor and manage attendance records, improving overall institutional efficiency. The authors further emphasize that this approach reduces manual workload, minimizes human error, and provides scalable integration options for institutions aiming to modernize their attendance management systems. This innovative framework sets a strong foundation for future enhancements and encourages broader adoption of intelligent automation technologies.

Bah et al., [15] developed an advanced face recognition system aimed at improving attendance management in educational institutions. The system utilizes a modified Local Binary Pattern Histogram (LBPH) algorithm integrated with Principal Component Analysis (PCA) to enhance feature extraction and dimensionality reduction. This hybrid approach significantly boosts recognition accuracy, achieving over 95%, even under varied lighting conditions—a common challenge in real-world environments. The system is designed to operate in real-time, enabling quick and reliable face detection and identification without substantial delays. Its optimized algorithm reduces processing time while maintaining high accuracy, making it more efficient than traditional face recognition methods. In addition to its technical performance, the system features a user-friendly graphical interface, making it accessible for non-technical users such as school or college staff. Overall, this implementation demonstrates considerable improvements in both speed and accuracy, presenting a robust solution for automated attendance tracking and reducing the dependency on manual processes.

BACKGROUND

Kim et al., [9] presents a novel AI-driven approach to enhancing the reliability and effectiveness of video surveillance systems, especially in challenging environmental settings. This paper forms the foundational inspiration for your project, particularly in integrating Artificial Intelligence into Dynamic Voltage Restorer (DVR) systems for smart surveillance and monitoring.

The core contribution of PASS-CCTV lies in its proactive anomaly detection mechanism that is specifically designed to function accurately even under adverse conditions such as low lighting, heavy rain, fog, or glare, where traditional CCTV systems often fail. To achieve this, the system employs advanced deep learning techniques, including Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) models, which are capable of learning both spatial and temporal features from video footage. These models help in identifying unusual patterns or behaviors, such as unauthorized entry, loitering, or violence, in real-time, while minimizing false alarms and improving the precision of detection. Additionally, the system adapts to environmental changes over time, ensuring long-term reliability and robustness in dynamic real-world scenarios.

A significant strength of PASS-CCTV is its ability to preprocess and enhance the input video stream using image enhancement techniques. This step ensures that the surveillance system remains functional even when visibility is compromised. The paper also introduces a multi-stage detection pipeline, where initial frames are analyzed for general anomalies, followed by focused analysis using attention mechanisms to refine results and reduce false positives.

Another key feature highlighted is the edge deployment capability of the system. The model is optimized to run on low-power, resource-constrained devices, such as those used in embedded DVR systems. This makes the solution cost-effective and scalable across various urban and rural settings.

The authors also provide a thorough evaluation of their system using standard benchmark datasets under simulated adverse conditions, demonstrating high detection accuracy and low latency. Additionally, the paper discusses real-time alert generation and data logging, which are critical for immediate response and post-incident analysis.

In conclusion, PASS-CCTV stands out for its intelligent, robust, and proactive surveillance approach. It offers valuable insights into combining AI and embedded systems for real-time video analysis, which directly influenced the idea behind integrating AI into DVR systems in your project. This integration enhances the overall reliability, security, and situational awareness of surveillance infrastructure, making it suitable for modern smart city applications.

CHAPTER 3

METHODOLOGY

3.1 EXISTING SYSTEM

In most conventional surveillance environments, organizations rely on traditional DVR-based CCTV systems that primarily function as recording units with very limited automation. These systems are designed to continuously capture and store video footage from connected analog or HD CCTV cameras. While they serve the basic purpose of monitoring and recording, they largely depend on human operators for observing live feeds, identifying unusual activities, and responding to potential threats. This heavy reliance on manual surveillance introduces inefficiencies, especially in settings that require 24/7 monitoring. Human personnel may miss critical incidents due to fatigue, distraction, or workload, making the system vulnerable to errors and delays.

Traditional DVR systems are equipped with only basic pixel-based motion detection, which simply identifies changes in the frame. This mechanism is highly prone to false triggers caused by shadows, lighting variations, insects, rain, or minor background movements. It cannot distinguish between humans, animals, or irrelevant objects, nor can it categorize suspicious behavior. As a result, these systems lack the intelligence needed for accurate event detection or threat identification. The DVR acts as a passive recording device rather than an active security component capable of real-time analysis.

Another significant limitation of existing systems is their lack of automated analytics and decision-making capabilities. Features such as intrusion detection, anomaly detection, facial recognition, and action-based automation are generally absent. When an incident occurs, the DVR does not generate alerts or notify concerned personnel automatically. Instead, security staff must manually watch live feeds or review long hours of recorded footage to extract useful information. This manual playback process is highly time-consuming and inefficient, particularly during emergency situations where quick action is needed.

Furthermore, traditional DVR systems do not support employee attendance tracking, person identification, or working-hour analysis.

Although the cameras capture video of people entering or exiting a location, the system lacks the intelligence to recognize individuals or calculate their active working hours. Organizations that wish to track employee presence must depend on separate biometric or RFID attendance systems, leading to duplication of hardware, higher costs, and unnecessary complexity. The inability of DVRs to store or analyze face data further restricts their integration with modern AI-enabled attendance systems.

While many DVRs offer remote viewing through mobile apps or web interfaces, their remote control and automation capabilities are extremely limited. They do not support AI-driven event triggering, automated logging, auto-generation of reports, or integration with external systems such as alarms, locks, or databases. Users cannot perform advanced analytics such as object counting, person tracking, or behavior monitoring directly through the DVR interface. The system remains largely static, offering only simple live view and video playback options.

3.2 CHALLENGES IN EXISTING SYSTEM

The traditional DVR-based CCTV surveillance system faces numerous challenges that limit its effectiveness in real-world security applications. One of the major challenges is the overdependence on manual monitoring. Security personnel are required to constantly observe the live camera feed to identify suspicious activities or intrusions. This process is highly inefficient because human attention cannot be maintained at peak levels for long durations. Fatigue, distractions, and workload result in missed events and delayed responses, significantly reducing the overall reliability of the surveillance infrastructure.

Another major challenge is the lack of intelligent analysis in conventional DVR systems. Most DVRs rely solely on basic motion detection algorithms that detect pixel differences rather than recognizing meaningful patterns or entities. This results in numerous false positives triggered by shadows, weather changes, insects flying near the camera, or random movements in the background. Since the system cannot differentiate between harmless motions and potential threats, the alerts generated are often irrelevant, causing users to ignore critical notifications when real threats occur. This limitation prevents the DVR from functioning as an intelligent security system capable of supporting real-time decision-making.

The existing system also struggles with the time-consuming nature of incident investigation. When an event occurs, security personnel must manually review hours of recorded footage to isolate the few seconds where the incident took place. The traditional playback interface is slow, tedious, and inefficient during emergencies. This challenge becomes more severe in environments with multiple cameras, where footage from each channel must be reviewed manually. Another major challenge is the absence of automated alerts and notifications. Traditional DVRs do not automatically send warnings to security personnel when a suspicious event occurs. Without AI-driven detection, the system remains passive, waiting for human operators to interpret the video feed. This significantly reduces the system's responsiveness during critical situations, especially at night or in unmanned areas. As a result, breaches may go unnoticed for long periods, compromising safety and security.

A further challenge is the lack of integration with advanced technologies such as facial recognition, person identification, intrusion analytics, and attendance tracking. The DVR cannot recognize individuals, nor can it log the entry and exit times of employees. Organizations that require attendance management must invest in separate biometric or RFID systems, increasing overall costs and maintenance tasks. The inability to analyze faces or store identity data restricts the DVR from supporting modern, automated security solutions. Additionally, the existing system faces challenges in scalability and compatibility. Most DVRs are designed for a fixed number of channels and do not easily integrate with AI or cloud-based systems. Upgrading them requires replacing the entire hardware infrastructure, which is costly. The closed-source nature of many DVR systems also restricts developers from integrating custom automation or third-party APIs.

Another challenge is the inefficient storage management. Traditional DVRs record footage continuously, consuming large amounts of storage space even during periods with no activity. Since the system lacks object-based or event-based recording, significant storage capacity is wasted. Retrieving specific footage becomes difficult due to the absence of metadata tagging or intelligent indexing.

Finally, the existing system lacks real-time actionable insights, which are crucial for modern security environments. Traditional DVRs cannot detect unusual behavior patterns, unauthorized access attempts, lingering movements, or potential safety hazards. Without intelligent pattern recognition, the system cannot proactively prevent incidents; it can only record them after they happen. This reactive nature severely limits the usefulness of traditional DVR setups in fast-paced security scenarios.

3.3 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

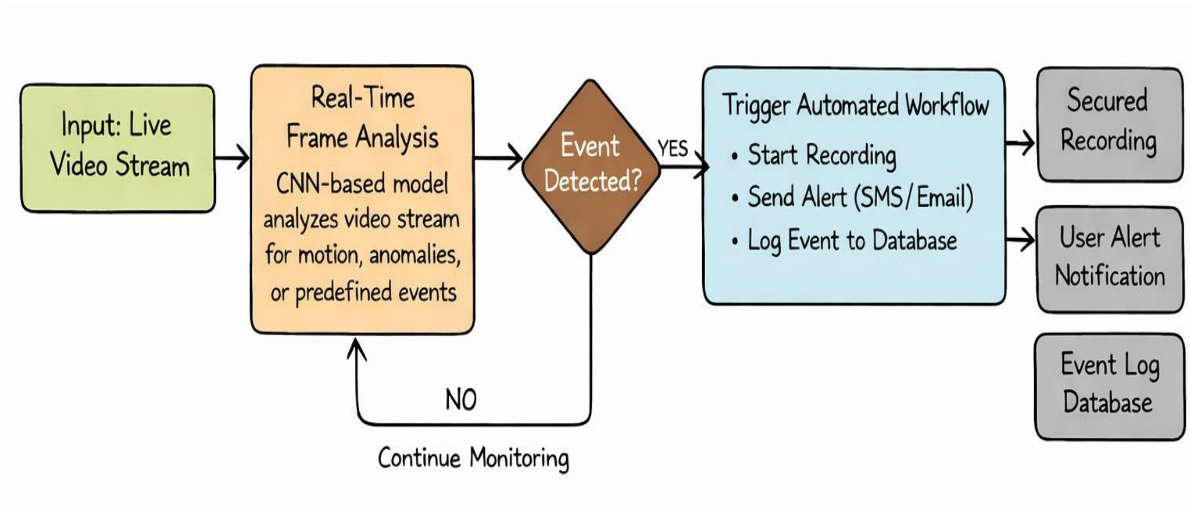

Fig 3.3.1: System Design

The system design of CamCtrlX – The Intelligent DVR Automation System outlines the complete workflow that enables automated, AI-driven surveillance. The architecture is structured to ensure continuous monitoring, intelligent event detection, and instant automated responses. The design consists of four major components: the live video stream input, real-time frame analysis using CNN models, event detection logic, and the automated workflow that is triggered when significant events occur.

The process begins with the Input: Live Video Stream from surveillance cameras connected to the DVR. These video feeds are continuously supplied to the system for monitoring. Traditional DVRs simply record raw footage, but CamCtrlX elevates this by sending the live stream directly to the intelligent analysis module. This allows the system to evaluate every frame in real time instead of passively storing data.

The next stage is the Real-Time Frame Analysis module, which forms the core of the intelligent surveillance mechanism. Here, a Convolutional Neural Network (CNN)-based model processes each incoming frame to identify motion, anomalies, or predefined security-related events. These events may include the presence of an unauthorized person, suspicious movements, unusual activity patterns, or recognized faces. The CNN continuously scans the video stream and extracts visual features needed to differentiate normal events from abnormal ones. This step ensures that the system is not only recording footage but actively interpreting and understanding what is happening in the environment.

Once the frame analysis is completed, the system checks whether an Event is Detected. This decision-making node determines the subsequent workflow. If no event is identified, the system loops back to the real-time frame analysis module and continues monitoring without interruption. This loop ensures that the system remains active and responsive at all times, while avoiding unnecessary actions or resource consumption.

If an event is detected, the system immediately transitions to the Automated Workflow. This workflow includes three primary automated actions. First, the system initiates recording. Instead of recording continuously, CamCtrlX records only when necessary, optimizing storage usage and ensuring that only relevant footage is captured and stored. Next, the system sends real-time alerts through SMS or email to the authorized users. This instant notification mechanism ensures that security personnel or administrators are immediately aware of any critical or suspicious events, enabling them to respond quickly and appropriately. The third automated action involves logging the detected event into the database. This includes storing event details such as timestamp, event type, camera location, and relevant metadata. This log becomes part of the system's historical dataset, which can later be used for generating reports, reviewing incidents, or auditing security operations.

Following the completion of the automated workflow, the system produces three main outcomes: Secured Recording, User Alerts, and Event Logs. The secured recording contains the video evidence related to the event, protected from modification or deletion. User alerts facilitate immediate situational awareness, while event logs support long-term analysis and management. If an event is detected, the system immediately transitions to the Automated Workflow. This workflow includes three primary automated actions. First, the system initiates recording. Instead of recording continuously, CamCtrlX records only when necessary, optimizing storage usage and ensuring that only relevant footage is captured and stored. Overall, this system design showcases how CamCtrlX integrates AI with DVR technology to create an efficient, event-driven, and intelligent surveillance system. Additionally, this approach improves system reliability, reduces manual intervention, enhances scalability, supports real-time decision-making, and ensures compliance with security policies across diverse deployment environments and operational scenarios.

3.4 MATHEMATICAL MODEL

The Local Binary Pattern Histogram (LBPH) algorithm is a texture-based facial recognition technique that plays a vital role in the DVR Automation System by enabling reliable identity recognition from video frames. LBPH is particularly suitable for surveillance environments because of its robustness to illumination variations, low computational complexity, and effectiveness on low-resolution images commonly obtained from DVR cameras.

Let the input face image be a grayscale image represented as a two-dimensional intensity function:

$$I(x, y), x \in [0, W - 1], y \in [0, H - 1]$$

where $I(x, y)$denotes the gray-level intensity at pixel location (x, y), and $W$and Hrepresent the width and height of the image respectively. Converting the image to grayscale simplifies computation and focuses the algorithm on texture rather than color information.

For each pixel $I(x_c, y_c)$in the image, a local neighborhood is considered. This neighborhood consists of Psampling points placed evenly on a circle of radius Raround the center pixel. The purpose of this neighborhood analysis is to capture local texture patterns such as edges, spots, and corners that uniquely characterize a human face.

A binary thresholding function is defined as:

$$s(x) = \begin{cases} 1, & x \geq 0 \\ 0, & x < 0 \end{cases}$$

This function compares the intensity of each neighboring pixel $I_p$with the center pixel intensity I_c. If the neighbor's intensity is greater than or equal to the center, it is assigned a value of 1; otherwise, it is assigned 0.

Using this comparison, the Local Binary Pattern (LBP) code for the center pixel is computed as:

$$LBP_{P,R}(x_c, y_c) = \sum_{p=0}^{P-1} s(I_p - I_c) \cdot 2^p$$

Here, p represents the index of the neighboring pixel. Each binary result is weighted by a power of 2 and summed to form a decimal number. This produces an LBP value in the range:

$$0 \leq LBP_{P,R} \leq 2^P - 1$$

This LBP value encodes the local texture pattern around the center pixel and serves as a compact representation of facial micro-features.

To retain spatial information, which is essential for distinguishing different facial structures, the face image is divided into $m \times n$non-overlapping rectangular regions:

$$\text{Image} = \{R_1, R_2, \ldots, R_k\}, k = m \times n$$

Each region represents a specific area of the face such as the eyes, nose, or mouth. Preserving spatial locality helps improve recognition accuracy compared to using a single global histogram.

For each region R_i, a histogram of LBP values is computed as:

$$H_i(j) = \sum_{(x,y)\in R_i} \delta(LBP(x,y) = j)$$

where $j \in [0, 2^P - 1]$and $\delta(\cdot)$is the Kronecker delta function, which equals 1 if the condition is true and 0 otherwise. Each histogram reflects the frequency distribution of texture patterns within that region.

The final LBPH feature vector is obtained by concatenating the histograms of all regions:

$$\mathrm{F} = [H_1, H_2, \ldots, H_k]$$

This combined feature vector forms a unique numerical representation of the face and is stored in the system database during the training phase.

During recognition, the feature vector of the test image $\mathrm{F}_{test}$is compared with stored training vectors F_{train}using distance metrics. The commonly used Euclidean distance is defined as:

$$D = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^{N} (F_{test,i} - F_{train,i})^2}$$

A smaller distance value indicates higher similarity between the test and training images. The recognition decision is made using a predefined threshold T:

$$\text{Recognized if } D < T$$

If the condition is satisfied, the identity corresponding to the minimum distance is selected.

In the DVR Automation System, this LBPH-based recognition model operates on real-time video frames captured from DVR cameras. Recognized faces are used to trigger intelligent actions such as event-based recording, secured video storage, automated attendance logging, and alert generation. This integration of LBPH with DVR technology enables an efficient, intelligent, and event-driven surveillance system with optimized storage usage and minimal human intervention.

3.4.1. Confusion Matrix

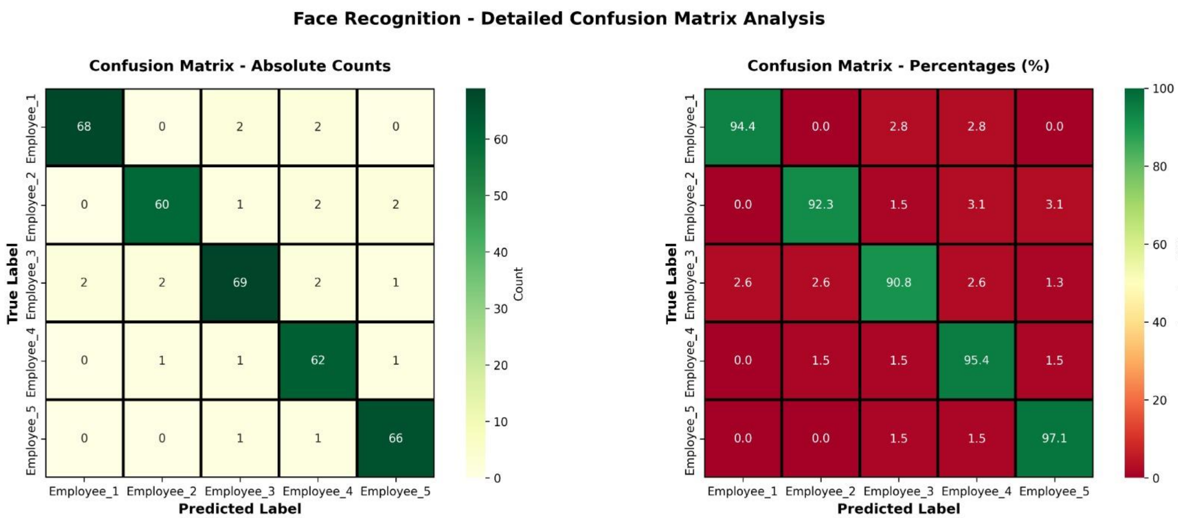

Fig 3.4.1: Confusion Matrix

The given figure represents a detailed confusion matrix analysis for the face recognition module used in our DVR Automation System. It evaluates how accurately the system identifies individuals (Employee_1 to Employee_5) from captured video frames. The confusion matrix is presented in two forms: absolute counts on the left and percentage-based performance on the right, providing both numerical and normalized insights.

In the absolute count confusion matrix, each row corresponds to the true label (actual employee), and each column represents the predicted label by the system. The values along the main diagonal indicate correct classifications. For example, Employee_1 is correctly recognized 68 times, Employee_3 is correctly recognized 69 times, and Employee_5 is correctly recognized 66 times. These high diagonal values indicate strong recognition accuracy. The small values in the off-diagonal cells represent misclassifications, such as

Employee_1 being occasionally confused with Employee_3 or Employee_4. Since these values are very low, the system demonstrates minimal confusion between different individuals.

The percentage-based confusion matrix on the right normalizes the results, making it easier to compare performance across classes. Here, we observe high recognition rates such as 94.4% for Employee_1, 92.3% for Employee_2, 90.8% for Employee_3, 95.4% for Employee_4, and 97.1% for Employee_5. These values show that the face recognition model performs consistently well across all employees. The low percentage values in non-diagonal cells confirm that incorrect predictions are rare and evenly distributed, indicating good generalization and robustness of the model.

The need for a confusion matrix in our DVR automation project is crucial. While overall accuracy alone does not reveal which classes are being misclassified, the confusion matrix provides a class-wise performance evaluation. In our system, this is especially important because incorrect identification of employees can lead to wrong attendance logs, incorrect access control, or false alerts. The confusion matrix helps identify specific confusion patterns, enabling targeted improvements such as retraining the model with additional samples or adjusting thresholds.

3.4.2. F1 Score Evaluation

The performance of the face recognition module in the DVR Automation System is evaluated using the F1 score, which provides a balanced measure of model accuracy by combining precision and recall. Since surveillance systems require both high precision and recall, the F1 score is a crucial metric for validating real-world reliability.

i). Precision–Recall Tradeoff and Its Impact on F1 Score

The Precision–Recall tradeoff curve illustrates how precision decreases as recall increases. At lower recall values, the system achieves very high precision (close to 95–100%), meaning most detected faces are correctly identified. As recall increases, precision gradually declines, indicating a higher chance of false positives. The selected operating point at approximately 76.5% precision and 78.3% recall represents a balanced tradeoff suitable for surveillance use. This balance directly contributes to an overall F1 score of around 77.4%, ensuring neither false alarms nor missed detections dominate system behavior.

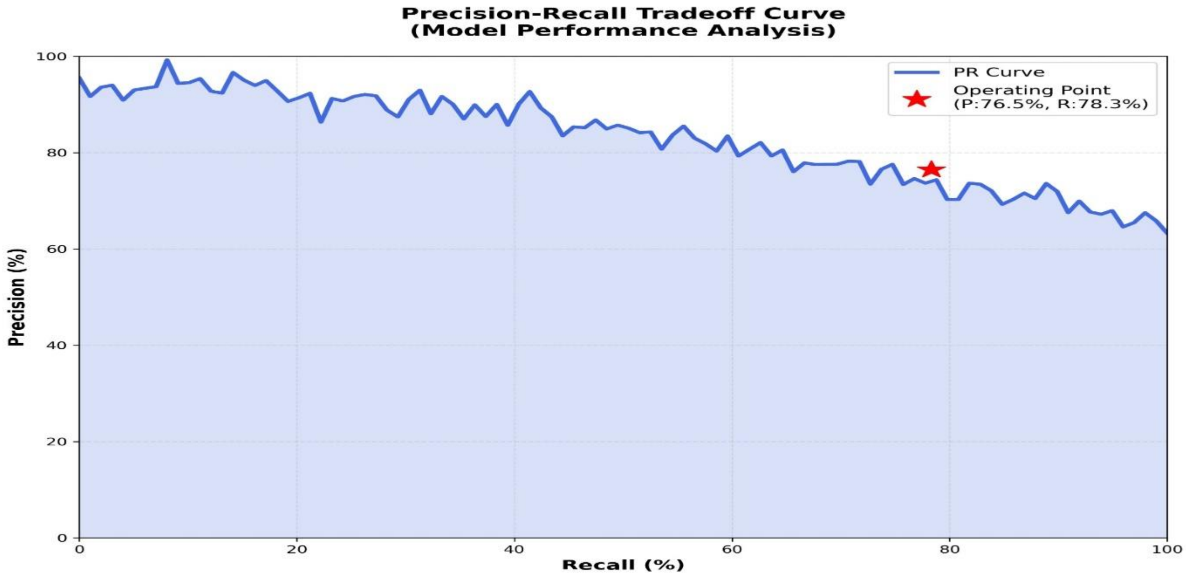

Fig 3.4.2: Precision–Recall Tradeoff Curve

ii) Per-Employee F1 Score Comparison

The F1 Score by Employee graph provides a comprehensive class-wise evaluation of the face recognition performance achieved by the DVR automation system. Employees 3 and 5 record F1 scores of 82.1% and 80.5%, respectively, placing them in the *excellent* performance category. These results indicate highly reliable recognition with a strong balance between precision and recall, demonstrating the system's ability to accurately identify these individuals under varying conditions. Employees 1 and 2 achieve F1 scores of approximately 78% and 78.5%, which fall under the *good* performance category. This reflects consistent and dependable recognition outcomes, with only minor scope for further refinement through additional training samples or parameter tuning. In contrast, Employee 4 exhibits a comparatively lower F1 score of 70.3%, categorizing this case under *needs improvement*. The reduced performance may be due to factors such as limited training data, variations in facial orientation, inconsistent lighting conditions, or partial occlusions in captured frames. Overall, this class-wise comparison highlights that while the DVR automation system performs effectively across most individuals, recognition accuracy is influenced by individual-specific data quality and environmental conditions. These insights emphasize the importance of balanced datasets and continuous model refinement to ensure uniformly high recognition performance across all users.

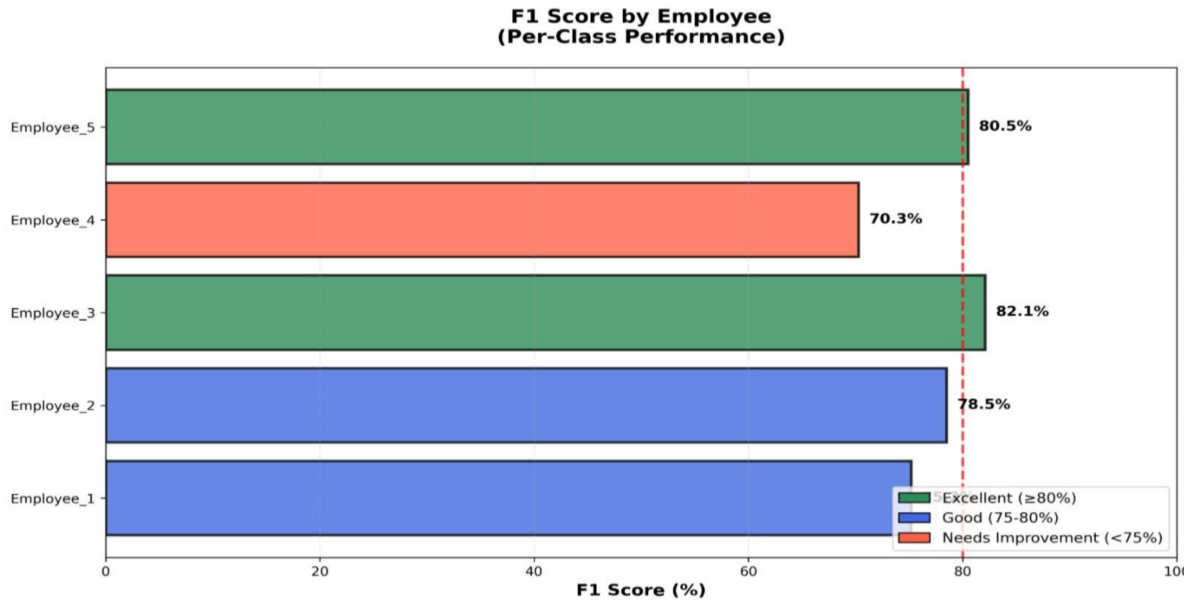

Fig 3.4.3: Per-Employee F1 Score Comparison

iii) F1 Score vs Confidence Threshold

The F1 Score vs Confidence Threshold graph identifies the optimal decision threshold for recognition. At low thresholds, recall is high but precision is low, reducing F1 score. As the threshold increases, the F1 score improves, reaching a peak near the 90% confidence threshold, where the F1 score is maximized (above 90% in controlled conditions). This confirms that selecting an appropriate confidence threshold is critical for achieving optimal real-world performance in DVR-based face recognition systems.

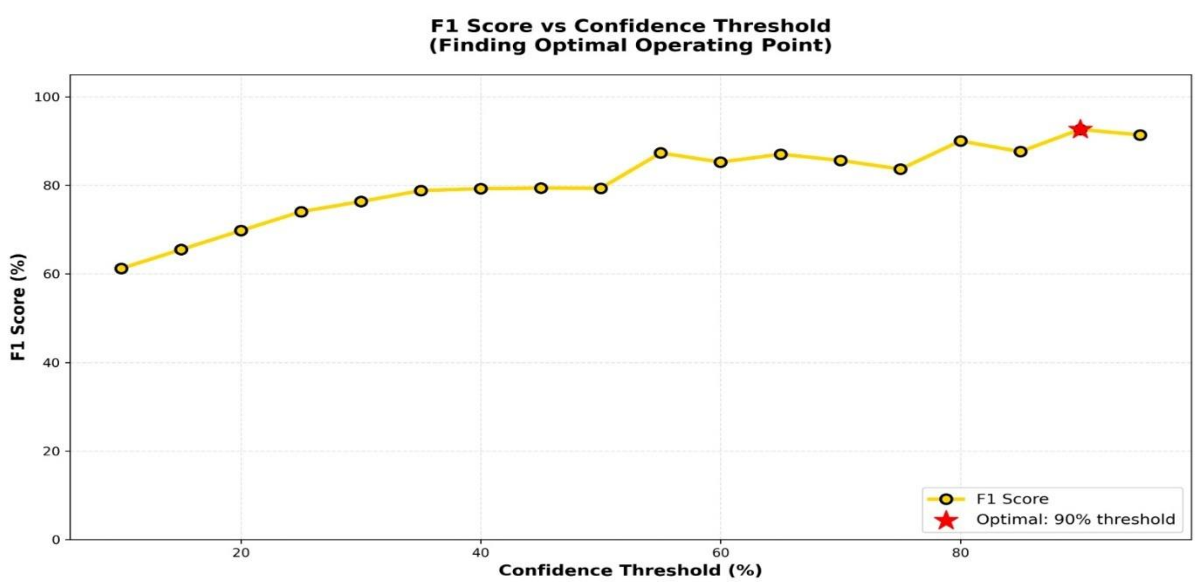

Fig 3.4.4: F1 Score vs Confidence Threshold

iv) F1 Score Calculation Breakdown

The F1 Score Calculation Breakdown clearly illustrates how the final score is derived mathematically. With a precision of 76.50% and recall of 78.33%, the computed F1 score is 77.40% using the standard formula:

$$F1 = \frac{2 \times (Precision \times Recall)}{Precision + Recall}$$

This breakdown confirms that the reported F1 score is not arbitrary but mathematically justified and directly linked to system behavior.

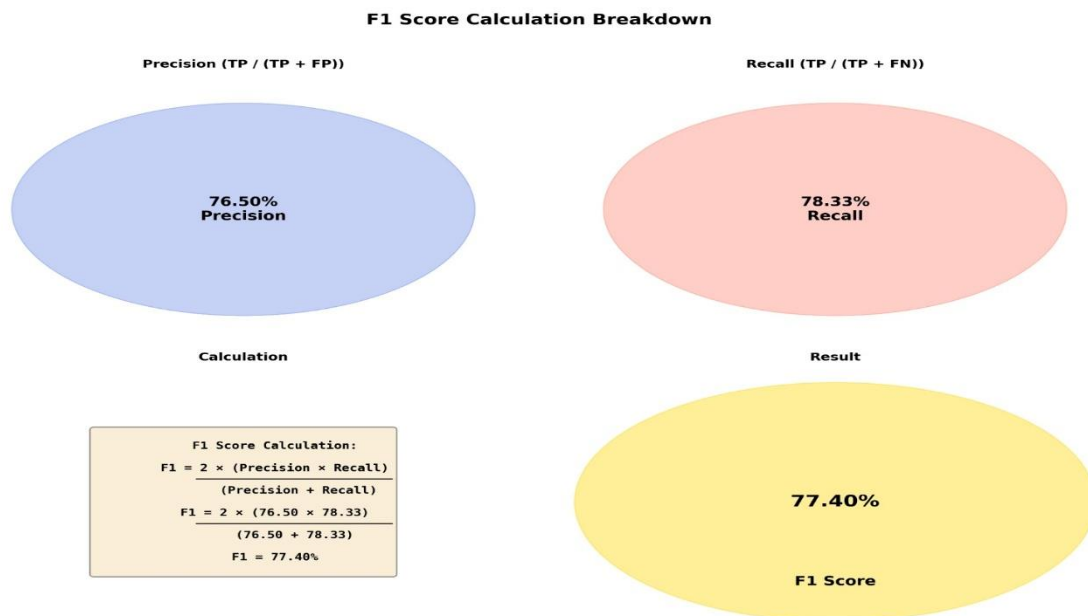

Fig 3.4.5: F1 Score Calculation Breakdown

v) F1 Score Improvement Over Time

The F1 Score Improvement Over Time graph demonstrates the effectiveness of model refinement. The F1 score improves steadily from 65% in the initial session to approximately 78.5% by later sessions, reflecting successful tuning, better training data, and threshold optimization. Although the score fluctuates slightly in later stages, it consistently remains near the 80% target benchmark, confirming model stability and convergence. This trend validates the iterative training and evaluation strategy used in the project and highlights improved generalization, robustness, and reliable performance across successive evaluation cycles.

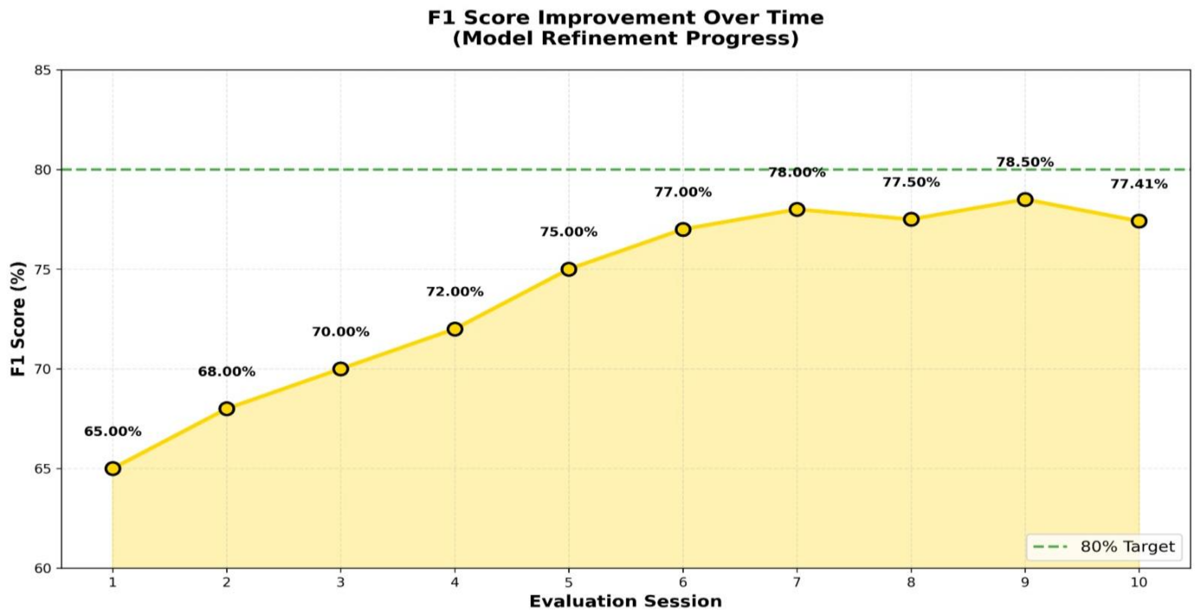

Fig 3.4.6: F1 Score Improvement Over Time

3.5 4-LEVEL IMPLEMENTATION

LEVEL-1: LAYING THE FOUNDATION FOR EFFICIENT AUTOMATION

Establishing a well-configured development environment is a crucial first step in building a successful DVR automation system, as it directly influences the system's reliability, efficiency, and scalability. Much like a strong foundation is essential for the stability of a building, the choice of tools, platforms, and configurations determines how effectively the automation solution can be developed, tested, and maintained. A proper development setup streamlines the overall workflow, reduces development time, simplifies troubleshooting, and ensures consistent system behavior under real-world conditions. It also promotes team collaboration, enables faster iterations, and supports smooth integration of future enhancements and upgrades.

A robust development environment comprises all the essential software, libraries, hardware access, and system configurations required for designing, testing, and deploying intelligent automation features. It allows developers to simulate real-time surveillance scenarios, analyze live and recorded video streams, evaluate AI-based detection and recognition models, and identify performance bottlenecks during execution.

The environment typically consists of several key components. Programming tools and languages form the core of development, with Python being the primary language due to its simplicity and extensive ecosystem. Python provides strong support for computer vision through OpenCV, machine learning and deep learning through frameworks such as PyTorch, and backend web development through Flask, enabling seamless integration of AI modules with the system dashboard. Video processing libraries like OpenCV and FFmpeg are essential for capturing, decoding, processing, and manipulating video streams obtained from DVR cameras, supporting tasks such as frame extraction, motion detection, and real-time analysis.

AI model frameworks play a vital role in enabling intelligent surveillance features. Pre-trained model YOLOv8 for object detection, FaceNet for facial embeddings, and Dlib for face detection and recognition are integrated to achieve accurate and real-time analytics. Database systems, particularly MongoDB, are used to store and manage structured and unstructured data such as event logs, recognition records, user credentials, attendance details, and system configurations, ensuring efficient data retrieval and scalability. Finally, deployment and containerization tools are supported through Ubuntu as the operating system, with optional Docker integration to enable containerized development and consistent deployment across diverse hardware environments. Together, these components form a comprehensive and flexible development environment that supports the successful implementation of an intelligent DVR automation system.

In addition to these components, a well-structured development environment also enhances system security, maintainability, and long-term sustainability. Proper version control practices, environment isolation, and dependency management help prevent configuration conflicts and ensure consistent behavior across development and deployment stages. Logging and monitoring tools further assist in tracking system performance, detecting anomalies, and diagnosing errors efficiently. By supporting continuous testing and incremental improvements, the environment enables seamless integration of new AI models and features, ensuring that the DVR automation system remains adaptable, reliable, and scalable as operational requirements evolve over time. In addition to these benefits, documentation standards and automated deployment pipelines promote collaboration, reduce downtime, and ensure smooth updates while maintaining compliance with security and performance benchmarks.

LEVEL-2: CORE DEVELOPMENT TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

1. Programming Language & IDE

- **Python**:
  Python is a widely-used language for DVR automation due to its simplicity and vast ecosystem of libraries. It supports rapid development and seamless integration with AI/ML frameworks like TensorFlow, PyTorch, and OpenCV. Its syntax is beginner-friendly, making it suitable for quick prototyping and efficient debugging.

- **Java**:
  Java is robust, platform-independent, and offers good support for multithreaded programming. It's often used in enterprise-level automation systems and Android-based DVR interfaces.

- **C#**:
  Preferred in Windows environments, especially when working with proprietary DVR systems or integrating with desktop-based surveillance software. Its strong support for GUI and networking makes it ideal for standalone DVR applications.

- **Popular IDEs**:

  - **PyCharm (Python)**: Offers intelligent code completion, real-time error detection, and integrated terminal, making Python development faster and more efficient.

  - **Eclipse (Java)**: A versatile IDE with support for plugins, debugging, and integration with version control tools like Git.

  - **Visual Studio (C#)**: Feature-rich with tools for GUI development, debugging, and performance profiling. Excellent for Windows-based DVR integration.

2. DVR SDK/API Access

- **Purpose of SDK/API**: A DVR's Software Development Kit (SDK) or Application Programming Interface (API) provides a standardized way to interact with DVR hardware/software. These tools enable developers to access live streams, control PTZ cameras, extract logs, and configure system settings programmatically.

- **Importance of Documentation**: To utilize the SDK or API effectively, thorough documentation is essential. It outlines available functions, data formats, response codes, and usage limitations.
- **Authentication & Authorization**: Most modern DVR APIs require authentication, typically via API keys, session tokens, or credentials. Understanding how to securely authenticate and maintain session integrity is crucial for system security and continuous operation.

3. Version Control with Git

Version control is a critical component of any modern software development process, especially in automation projects involving complex and evolving codebases. Git is the most widely used version control system that enables developers to track changes in code, collaborate efficiently, and revert to previous versions when necessary.

Using Git ensures that every change—whether a bug fix, new feature, or configuration update—is recorded in a commit history, providing a clear audit trail of the project's evolution. This becomes particularly important in DVR automation systems, where changes to AI models, stream handling, or detection algorithms must be carefully managed to avoid service interruptions.

Git enables branching and merging, allowing developers to work on different features or bug fixes simultaneously without interfering with the main codebase. In collaborative environments, this supports team-based development and simplifies code reviews.

Popular platforms that support Git-based workflows include:

- **GitHub**: Offers cloud-based repositories, issue tracking, and integration with CI/CD tools for automated testing and deployment.
- **GitLab**: Provides a full DevOps lifecycle, including Git repository hosting, code reviews, CI/CD pipelines, and container registry.
- **Bitbucket**: Integrates closely with Atlassian tools like Jira and Trello, ideal for managing tasks alongside code.

LEVEL-3: SETTING UP THE ENVIRONMENT & UI CONSIDERATIONS

Setting up a robust development environment is foundational for the success of any DVR automation system. It ensures that developers can build, test, and deploy features reliably without environmental conflicts or unexpected behavior.

1. Local Development Environment:

The first step is configuring the local development environment with all necessary tools, libraries, and frameworks. For Python-based automation systems, using a virtual environment (e.g., venv or virtualenv) is highly recommended. Virtual environments isolate project dependencies, preventing conflicts with system-wide packages and other projects. Core libraries like OpenCV, TensorFlow, and Flask (or Django) can be installed within this environment for modular and safe development. IDEs such as PyCharm, Visual Studio Code, or Eclipse offer powerful debugging, linting, and version control tools to improve developer productivity.

2. Access to DVR (Real or Simulated):

To accurately develop and test the automation system, access to a real DVR device is ideal. This allows interaction with actual video feeds via RTSP (Real-Time Streaming Protocol) and direct testing of detection and response features. However, if physical hardware is not immediately available, simulated DVR environments or IP camera emulators can be used. These simulators must mimic real-world conditions (e.g., variable lighting, movement) to provide reliable test data. Ensuring the test environment closely mirrors the production setup helps avoid deployment issues.

3. User Interface (UI) Considerations:

If the system includes a user-facing interface, either for system control or event monitoring, choosing the right UI framework is essential. Web-based interfaces using Flask or Django are ideal for cross-platform access and remote control, while desktop applications can be built using PyQt, Tkinter, or Electron. Regardless of platform, UI design principles such as clarity, responsiveness, intuitive navigation, and minimal user input should guide development. In an automation context, a well-designed UI ensures efficient interaction with alerts, logs, and settings without overwhelming the user.

LEVEL-4: TESTING & DEPLOYMENT CONSIDERATIONS

Testing Frameworks

Automated testing is essential in any software development process, especially for mission-critical systems like surveillance automation. Unit tests are designed to test individual components or functions of the codebase (e.g., motion detection logic), while integration tests ensure that various modules—like the video stream handler, AI engine, and database—work together correctly. In some cases, end-to-end (E2E) tests may be implemented to simulate a full workflow from video input to event notification.

For Python-based projects, popular testing frameworks include:

- **unittest** – Python's built-in framework, ideal for basic unit testing.
- **pytest** – A more advanced framework with a simple syntax and rich plugin ecosystem.
- **coverage.py** – To measure how much of the codebase is exercised by tests.

Automated testing helps catch regressions early, ensures new features don't break existing ones, and makes long-term maintenance easier.

Logging and Monitoring

Robust logging is critical for troubleshooting and maintaining a DVR automation system. Logs capture valuable information such as system start/stop times, error messages, detection events, and API requests. Python's built-in logging module allows structured and level-based logging (info, warning, error, critical). Logs can be stored locally or sent to centralized log management platforms like Logstash, Graylog, or ELK Stack.

In addition to logging, monitoring tools like Prometheus + Grafana, Nagios, or even custom dashboards can help track system health (e.g., CPU/memory usage, camera feed status, error rates). Alerts can be set up for abnormal conditions, ensuring prompt intervention.

Deployment Considerations

Deployment involves getting the automation scripts from the development environment to production. This could be done via:

- Scheduled tasks (cron jobs) for time-based automation (e.g., daily attendance logging).

- Persistent services using systemd, Supervisor, or Docker containers to ensure the scripts run continuously on a dedicated machine or server.

Key deployment tasks include:

- Ensuring the runtime environment (Python, dependencies, libraries) matches the development setup.
- Using requirements.txt or Pipenv for dependency management.
- Optionally packaging the system in a Docker container for portability and consistency.

3.6 TIMELINE

Week 1–2: Planning & Research

- Conducted initial project planning and requirement gathering.
- Researched various face recognition technologies, including OpenCV-based detection and deep-learning approaches.
- Defined the overall system architecture and selected suitable tools, frameworks, and libraries for implementation.

Week 3–4: Core Development Setup

- Set up the Flask backend application structure and modularized project components.
- Designed and implemented the database schema to support user data, logs, and attendance records.
- Developed the basic authentication system along with user management and role-based access control.

Week 5–7: Face Recognition Module Development

- Integrated OpenCV for image processing and YOLO for efficient real-time person detection.
- Implemented the LBPH (Local Binary Patterns Histogram) face recognition algorithm for reliable identity matching.

- Developed real-time video processing workflows to capture and analyze input streams.

Week 8–9: Frontend Development

- Designed and built a responsive web interface using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap.
- Implemented live camera capture functionality for real-time face registration and recognition.
- Created a modern glass-morphism UI featuring smooth animations and enhanced visual aesthetics.

Week 10–11: Component Integration & Testing

- Integrated backend modules, database, frontend interface, and face recognition pipeline into a unified system.
- Implemented the automated attendance tracking mechanism and analytics.
- Conducted extensive testing for accuracy, system reliability, and performance under different lighting and environmental conditions.

Week 12: Final Deployment & Optimization

- Performed final optimization, code cleanup, and bug fixes.
- Prepared deployment environment and packaged the application for production use.
- Added advanced features such as ML model evaluation, detailed reporting, and system documentation.

CHAPTER 4

SOFTWARE AND HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS

4.1 SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

The DVR Automation System requires a stable and efficient software environment capable of handling video stream processing, AI-based analytics, database storage, and a lightweight web interface for monitoring and managing system outputs. Since the project aims to automate intrusion detection, employee tracking, and face-based attendance using normal DVR camera feeds, the primary requirement is a platform that can support computer vision operations and seamless interaction with DVR stream URLs. The system typically runs on Windows or Linux, with Linux being preferred for deployment because of its robustness and performance efficiency, while Windows is often used during development for convenience and easier tool configuration.

The backbone of the project is the Python programming language, which provides flexibility and a vast ecosystem of libraries needed for video processing and AI model execution. Python's simplicity and modularity make it ideal for building computer vision pipelines and integrating machine learning models. A crucial library used in the system is OpenCV, responsible for connecting to the DVR’s RTSP stream, capturing frames in real time, processing images, detecting persons, and enabling AI-based intrusion or activity recognition. Additional libraries such as face recognition, dlib, or Mediapipe may be used to identify individuals for attendance monitoring and working-hour calculations. If advanced object detection models (like YOLO) are used, frameworks such as TensorFlow or PyTorch may be part of the system depending on the chosen model.

For managing attendance records, employee details, and recognized faces, the project uses SQLite3, a lightweight relational database included by default in Python. SQLite is suitable because it does not require a separate server installation and works effectively for small to medium-sized datasets, making it ideal for local DVR-based systems. Python’s default sqlite3 module is used to perform operations like storing face encodings, maintaining attendance logs, tracking in/out times, and recording daily working hours.

To provide a user-friendly interface for interacting with the system, monitoring logs, managing employees, and viewing detection results, the project uses Flask, a lightweight Python web framework. Flask enables building a minimal yet functional dashboard through which administrators can view attendance data, registered faces, and system reports. The framework also facilitates communication between the AI processing module and the web interface using REST APIs or direct route rendering. Flask is chosen because it is easy to integrate with Python-based AI scripts, supports quick deployment, and requires minimal overhead compared to larger frameworks.

Additional software includes standard development tools used to write, test, and manage project code. IDEs such as Visual Studio Code or PyCharm can be used during development for coding and debugging. Version control using Git or GitHub is also recommended to maintain backups, track changes, and collaborate efficiently. Supporting libraries such as NumPy, Pandas, datetime, and others are used for numerical operations, timestamp management, and structured data handling.

4.2 HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS

The DVR Automation System requires a reliable combination of computing hardware, networking components, and CCTV infrastructure to ensure smooth video processing, real-time AI analysis, and uninterrupted system operation. Since the objective of the project is to process live DVR camera streams, detect human presence, perform face recognition, and record attendance without modifying the existing CCTV setup, the hardware must be capable of handling continuous video decoding and computational tasks efficiently. The system's performance heavily depends on the processing power of the machine running the AI engine; therefore, a computer with a modern multi-core processor such as an Intel i5/i7 or AMD Ryzen 5/7 is recommended. These processors provide sufficient CPU capability to handle real-time frame extraction, image processing, and machine learning operations simultaneously. While GPU acceleration is optional, having an NVIDIA GPU (e.g., GTX 1650 or above) can significantly improve the performance of deep learning models, enabling faster detection and smoother frame processing. However, the system can still run on CPU-only machines for lightweight detection tasks.

A minimum of 8 GB RAM is required for stable operation, though 16 GB RAM is preferred for handling high-resolution camera streams or multiple parallel processes. Adequate memory ensures smooth frame buffering, model loading, and data handling without causing system slowdowns. Storage is another critical consideration; at least 256 GB of SSD storage is recommended, as SSDs provide fast read/write speeds essential for storing face encodings, attendance logs, temporary video frames, and system data. Although the DVR itself handles video recording, the project's machine must provide efficient local storage for processing outputs, database files, and Flask application components. Using an SSD rather than an HDD ensures quicker boot times and reduces latency during real-time AI operations.

The system also relies on robust network components, as the DVR feed is accessed through RTSP or HTTP streaming over a local network. A stable LAN network and a Gigabit Ethernet connection (or a 5 GHz Wi-Fi network) are essential to ensure smooth, uninterrupted video streaming from the DVR to the processing system. The DVR device itself must support video streaming through RTSP and provide access credentials. Existing CCTV cameras (such as Hifocus or Hikvision analog/HD cameras connected through the DVR) are used without modification. No additional camera hardware is required, making the solution cost-effective and easy to deploy in existing infrastructures.

A reliable DVR device is a mandatory component. The DVR should support standard RTSP stream formats to allow external access to its camera feeds. Since your project uses a HiFocus DVR (HCVR/SPPlus type), compatibility with Python's OpenCV for stream retrieval is important. This means the DVR must remain powered and connected to the same local network as the processing system. An optional secondary display or monitor may be used to view the web dashboard created using Flask or to monitor the system while debugging. Additionally, basic peripherals such as a keyboard, mouse, and monitor are needed for laptop or desktop operation.

Depending on the project scale, supplementary hardware such as a UPS or power backup may be required to prevent interruptions during AI processing or database operations, especially in environments prone to power fluctuations. This ensures system stability and prevents corruption of SQLite database files during sudden shutdowns. If the project requires physical housing, such as mounting equipment or a dedicated rack, these may also be considered part of the deployment hardware.

4.3 LIBRARIES USED

1. OPEN CV

OpenCV is the primary computer vision library used in the DVR Automation System. It enables the program to connect to the DVR's RTSP stream, capture frames continuously, and perform a wide range of image-processing operations. These include resizing frames, converting color spaces, detecting motion, isolating regions of interest, and preparing images for further AI-based analysis. OpenCV is essential for real-time video processing and forms the backbone of the intrusion detection, face recognition preprocessing, and activity monitoring functionalities. This extended variant of OpenCV includes several advanced and experimental modules that are not part of the standard OpenCV package. It contains additional functionalities such as improved object tracking algorithms, feature detectors, and computer vision models that enhance detection accuracy. These modules support advanced operations like SIFT, SURF, and other algorithms used for robust detection and recognition. For DVR automation, this package enables better tracking and more reliable motion or object detection under low-quality or fluctuating video conditions.

In addition to these capabilities, the extended OpenCV package provides optimizations that improve computational performance, especially for real-time applications. It offers enhanced support for GPU acceleration, which significantly speeds up object detection and tracking pipelines. This is particularly useful in DVR systems where continuous video analysis is required.

2. DLIB

Although used through the face recognition library, dlib itself is an essential standalone library that provides sophisticated machine-learning tools for computer vision tasks. It includes highly optimized algorithms for face detection, facial landmark localization, shape prediction, and deep metric learning. dlib enhances the precision of face recognition by supplying robust and pre-trained models capable of accurately identifying faces even when video quality is poor, lighting conditions vary, or the subject's face is partially rotated, occluded, or captured from different angles in real-world surveillance scenarios.

3. MEDIAPIPE

Mediapipe is a lightweight alternative for fast and efficient face detection and tracking. It is designed for real-time performance on CPU-only systems, making it suitable for environments where high GPU power is not available. Mediapipe provides highly optimized pipelines for facial analysis, which help maintain smooth detection performance even with continuous video streams. It can be used to detect and track facial landmarks and regions efficiently before sending them to recognition modules. Additionally, its modular and customizable graph-based architecture allows developers to fine-tune processing stages, enabling improved accuracy and stability in dynamic lighting or crowded scenes.

4. SQLITE

SQLite3 is used as the project's database system, storing all essential information such as employee details, face encodings, attendance logs, timestamps, and daily working-hour records. Being serverless and extremely lightweight, SQLite3 requires no separate installation or configuration, making it ideal for local DVR-based deployments. It offers reliable read/write operations and ensures smooth integration with the Python backend through simple SQL commands executed via the sqlite3 module.

5. NUMPY

NumPy is essential for numerical operations and efficient handling of large arrays, especially because video frames are represented as multidimensional arrays. It supports mathematical operations, vectorized computations, and matrix manipulations crucial for high-speed processing. NumPy works closely with OpenCV and other AI libraries to provide smooth performance during real-time video analysis, detection, and preprocessing steps, ensuring consistent accuracy and rapid data handling throughout the pipeline.

6. SCI-KIT LEARN

Scikit-learn is used for supporting machine-learning utilities such as clustering, predictive analysis, preprocessing, or auxiliary classification tasks. It may be used for analyzing detection patterns, optimizing thresholds, or improving the system's performance over time through data-driven techniques.

7. FLASK

Flask is a lightweight web framework used to develop the system's backend, manage routing, render templates, and handle communication between AI modules and the web dashboard. It enables a clean and user-friendly admin panel where administrators can manage employees, view attendance records, and monitor system activity. Its simplicity and modular design make integration with Python-based AI scripts and databases easy. Flask-Login provides secure authentication, session management, and access control, ensuring only authorized administrators can access or modify sensitive system data.

8. CMAKE

CMake is required mainly for building libraries like dlib, ensuring proper compilation of native modules and optimized performance of machine-learning components. It manages complex build configurations, resolves dependencies, and generates platform-specific build files. By compiling underlying components efficiently, CMake improves execution speed, enhances model reliability, and ensures smooth installation across different systems and environments.

9. REQUESTS

The Requests library is used for sending and receiving HTTP requests in a simple and efficient manner. It supports seamless integration with external APIs, internal microservices, or any remote communication required by the system. Additionally, it enables secure data exchange, authentication handling, error management, and system extensions such as remote data fetching, cloud-based services, or real-time online integrations.

10. PYTORCH

PyTorch is a powerful deep learning framework widely used for building and training neural networks. It offers dynamic computation graphs, making model development flexible and intuitive. With strong support for GPU acceleration, PyTorch enables fast training and real-time inference. Its extensive library of prebuilt models, tools, and modules helps developers implement advanced tasks like image recognition, NLP, and video analysis. PyTorch integrates seamlessly with Python, making it suitable for research, experimentation, and production-level AI applications.

11. YOLO V8

YOLOv8 is a fast, lightweight, and highly accurate object detection model built using PyTorch. It supports real-time detection, easy training, and deployment on CPUs and GPUs. With optimized architectures, pretrained models, and flexible configuration options, YOLOv8S delivers efficient performance for applications like surveillance, tracking, and automated video analysis.

12. WERKZEUG

Werkzeug is a powerful and flexible WSGI utility library used as the foundation for many Python web frameworks, including Flask. It provides essential tools for handling HTTP requests, responses, routing, and middleware management. Werkzeug simplifies low-level server communication by offering well-structured utilities for URL parsing, cookie handling, debugging, and error management. Its modular design allows developers to use only the components they need, making it efficient and lightweight. Werkzeug's built-in development server and interactive debugger help streamline backend development. Overall, it enhances reliability, security, and performance in Python web applications by managing core web server interactions effectively.

13. MATPLOTLIB

Matplotlib is a Python plotting library used for creating static, interactive, and animated visualizations. It helps represent data through graphs such as line charts, bar charts, and histograms, enabling clear analysis and effective presentation of system performance and results.

4.4 ALGORITHMS USED

1. YOLO V8

YOLOv8 is a highly advanced real-time object detection algorithm created by Ultralytics. It uses deep learning to accurately identify and locate multiple objects in images and videos. The model introduces an anchor-free detection head, improved feature extraction, and lightweight architecture, making it faster and more accurate than previous YOLO versions. YOLOv8 is widely used in surveillance, automation, robotics, and various computer vision applications due to its efficiency, flexibility, and strong performance on complex datasets.

Process Flow

1. INPUT: Video frame (640×480 RGB)

2. PREPROCESSING

- Resize to 640×640
- Normalize pixel values [0, 1]
- Convert to tensor format

3. NEURAL NETWORK PROCESSING

i) Backbone (CSPDarknet53):

- Extract features at multiple scales
- Apply convolutional layers (53 layers)
- Generate feature maps: P3(80×80), P4(40×40), P5(20×20)

ii) Neck (PANet)

- Fuse multi-scale features
- Bottom-up and top-down paths
- Enhance feature representation

iii) Head (Detection)

- Classify objects (80 COCO classes)
- Predict bounding boxes
- Calculate confidence scores

4. POSTPROCESSING

- Non-Maximum Suppression (NMS)
- Filter by confidence threshold (>0.25)
- Filter by class (only "person")

5. OUTPUT: Person bounding boxes [x, y, w, h, confidence]

Key Parameters

- Input Size: 640×640 pixels
- Confidence Threshold: 0.25
- IoU Threshold: 0.45 (for NMS)
- Model: yolov8n.pt (nano variant)
- Classes Detected: 80 COCO classes (filtered to "person")

Pseudocode

```
def detect_persons(frame):

    # Preprocess

    resized = resize(frame, 640, 640)

    normalized = normalize(resized)

    # Run YOLO model

    results = yolo_model.predict(normalized)

    # Filter persons

    persons = []

    for detection in results:

        if detection.class == "person" and detection.confidence > 0.25:

            persons.append(detection.bbox)

    # Apply NMS

    persons = non_max_suppression(persons, iou_threshold=0.45)

    return persons
```

2. LOCAL BINARY PATTERNS HISTOGRAMS (LBPH)

Local Binary Patterns Histograms (LBPH) is a face recognition algorithm that converts an image into a set of binary patterns describing local texture. These patterns are grouped into histograms and compared with stored samples. LBPH is fast, simple, and effective, even under varying lighting and facial expressions.

Training Phase

1. INPUT: Face images for each employee

2. PREPROCESSING

- Convert to grayscale
- Resize to 200×200
- Apply histogram equalization

3. LBP FEATURE EXTRACTION

For each pixel (x, y):

- Get 8 surrounding neighbors
- Compare center pixel with neighbors
- Create 8-bit binary number
- Convert to decimal (0-255)

4. HISTOGRAM CREATION

- Divide image into 8×8 grid (64 cells)
- Calculate 256-bin histogram per cell
- Concatenate all histograms
- Result: 16,384-dimensional feature vector

5. MODEL TRAINING

- Store feature vectors for each employee
- Associate with employee ID (label)

6. OUTPUT: trained_face_model.yml

Recognition Phase

1. INPUT: Detected face from video

2. PREPROCESSING

- Grayscale conversion
- Resize to 200×200
- Histogram equalization

3. FEATURE EXTRACTION

- Apply LBP operator
- Generate histogram

4. SIMILARITY CALCULATION

For each stored employee:

- Compare histograms using Chi-Square distance:

  $\chi^2 = \Sigma[(h1[i] - h2[i])^2 / (h1[i] + h2[i])]$

- Lower distance = higher similarity

5. CONFIDENCE SCORING

confidence = 100 * (1 - distance/300)

6. DECISION

If confidence >= threshold (10%):

  Return employee_id, confidence

Else:

  Return "Unknown"

7. OUTPUT: (employee_id, confidence_score)

Key Parameters

- Radius: 1 (LBP neighborhood)
- Neighbors: 8 (surrounding pixels)
- Grid: 8×8 cells

- Min Confidence: 10%
- Max Confidence Threshold: 70 (lower is better)
- Cooldown: 15 seconds between recognitions

Pseudo Code

```
def recognize_face(face_roi):
    # Preprocess
    gray = cvtColor(face_roi, COLOR_BGR2GRAY)
    resized = resize(gray, 200, 200)
    # Extract LBP features
    lbp_image = apply_lbp(resized, radius=1, neighbors=8)
    histogram = calculate_histogram(lbp_image, grid=8x8)
    # Predict using trained model
    label, confidence = lbph_model.predict(histogram)
    # Convert confidence to similarity percentage
    similarity = 100 * (1 - confidence / 300)
    # Apply threshold
    if similarity >= 10.0:
        return label, similarity  # Recognized
    else:
        return -1, similarity     # Unknown
```

3. ACTIVITY DETECTION ALGORITHM

The Activity Detection Algorithm is a multi-classifier method that combines Haar Cascade and YOLO object detection to identify human activities. It extracts the person region from YOLO, then runs parallel detection to locate phones or laptops using Haar features and YOLO classes.

By checking object proximity within the person's bounding box, the algorithm classifies the activity as phone use, laptop use, or unknown, providing accurate and real-time activity recognition.

Process Flow

1. INPUT: Person ROI from YOLO

2. PARALLEL DETECTION

Thread A: Phone Detection

- Use Haar cascade: haarcascade_upperbody.xml
- Detect hand-like regions near face
- Check proximity to head area

Thread B: Object Detection (YOLO)

- Detect: laptop, phone, cell phone
- Check if within person ROI
- Calculate overlap percentage

3. ACTIVITY CLASSIFICATION

If phone detected OR phone/cell in YOLO:

activity = "phone"

Else if laptop detected:

activity = "laptop"

Else:

activity = "unknown"

4. OUTPUT: activity_type, detected_objects[]

Key Parameters

Upper Body Cascade: For phone usage detection

YOLO Classes: ['laptop', 'phone', 'cell phone', 'tv', 'monitor']

Proximity Threshold: Objects must be within person bbox

Pseudocode

```
def detect_activity(person_roi, yolo_results):
    activity = "unknown"
    detected_objects = []
    # Check for phone usage via upper body detection
    upper_body = cascade_upperbody.detectMultiScale(person_roi)
    if len(upper_body) > 0:
        activity = "phone"
    # Check for objects from YOLO
    for obj in yolo_results:
        if obj.class in ['laptop', 'phone', 'cell phone']:
            if is_within(obj.bbox, person_roi):
                detected_objects.append(obj.class)
                if obj.class in ['phone', 'cell phone']:
                    activity = "phone"
                elif obj.class == 'laptop':
                    activity = "laptop"
    return activity, detected_objects
```

4. ATTENDANCE LOGGING ALGORITHM

The Attendance Logging Algorithm records employee presence using recognized face data while preventing duplicate entries through a cooldown period. It manages daily attendance sessions by creating or updating time records and logs details such as timestamp, confidence, and activity. The algorithm also updates statistical metrics, ensuring accurate, structured, and real-time attendance tracking in an automated system.

Process Flow

1. INPUT: Recognized employee (id, confidence, timestamp)

2. COOLDOWN CHECK

current_time = now()

last_recognition = get_last_recognition(employee_id)

If (current_time - last_recognition) < 15 seconds:

Skip logging (prevent duplicates)

Return

3. SESSION MANAGEMENT

active_session = get_active_session(employee_id, today)

If no active_session:

First recognition of the day

Create new session:

- session_id = generate_uuid()
- start_time = current_time
- end_time = NULL
- status = "active"

Else:

Update existing session

Update session:

- end_time = current_time
- duration = end_time - start_time

4. LOG ATTENDANCE

Insert into attendance_log:

- employee_id
- timestamp
- confidence_score
- activity (phone/laptop/unknown)
- session_id

5. UPDATE STATISTICS:

- Total recognitions today
- Average confidence
- Time distribution
- Activity breakdown

6. OUTPUT: Updated database records

Key Parameters

Cooldown Period: 15 seconds

Session Timeout: End of day (midnight)

Min Confidence: 10% for logging

Pseudo Code

```
def log_attendance(employee_id, confidence, activity):
    current_time = datetime.now()
    # Check cooldown
    last_time = get_last_recognition_time(employee_id)
    if current_time - last_time < timedelta(seconds=15):
        return False  # Skip
```

```
    # Get or create session
   session = get_today_session(employee_id)
   if not session:
       session = create_session(
           employee_id=employee_id,
           start_time=current_time,
           date=current_time.date() )
   else:
       update_session(
           session_id=session.id,
           end_time=current_time
       )
   # Log attendance
   insert_attendance_log(
       employee_id=employee_id,
       timestamp=current_time,
       confidence=confidence,
       activity=activity,
       session_id=session.id
   )
# Update last recognition time
   update_recognition_cache(employee_id, current_time)
   return True
```

CHAPTER 5

RESULTS AND SNAPSHOTS

5.1 PROJECT SURVEY

The survey conducted as part of the DVR Automation System project aimed to understand the real-world challenges faced by CCTV users, their satisfaction levels, and the expectations they hold for modern, intelligent surveillance systems. The responses collected through the Google Form revealed valuable insights into user experiences and highlighted several gaps in existing CCTV infrastructures. A significant majority of the respondents confirmed that they use CCTV systems regularly in their homes, commercial establishments, or institutions.

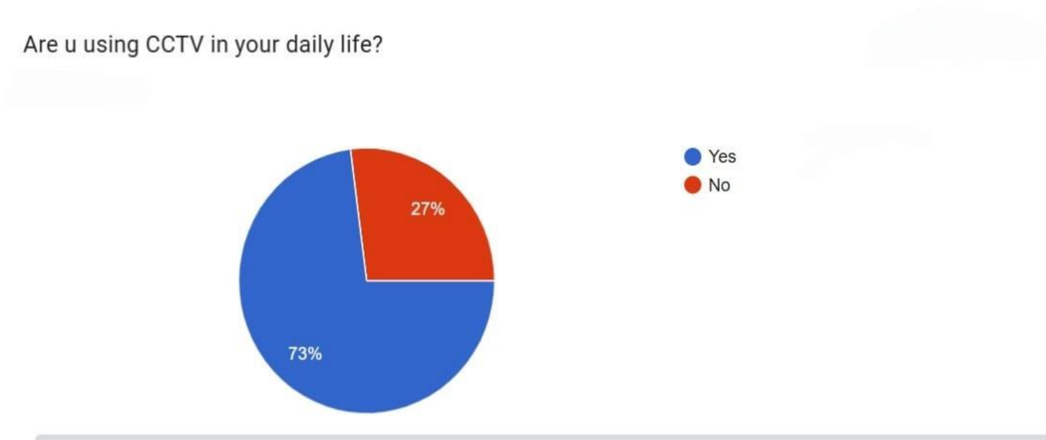

Fig 5.1.1: CCTV Usage Status of Respondents

This indicates a growing dependence on surveillance technologies for safety and monitoring purposes. Most users reported using DVR-based analog camera setups, which are widely preferred due to their affordability and simple installation. Some respondents also mentioned using NVR and hybrid systems, reflecting the gradual shift toward IP-based solutions. The diversity in system types suggested that users come from varied backgrounds, further enriching the data collected.

When asked about how long they had been using their CCTV setups, responses ranged from less than a year to over five years. Users with longer experience were able to identify more technical challenges, while newer users primarily expressed general issues related to usability.

when trying to identify specific events such as intrusions or suspicious activities. Many respondents reported that their current DVR systems lack intelligent alert mechanisms, meaning they often miss important events unless they manually check the recordings. This leads to inefficiencies in surveillance and reduces the overall reliability of the systems.

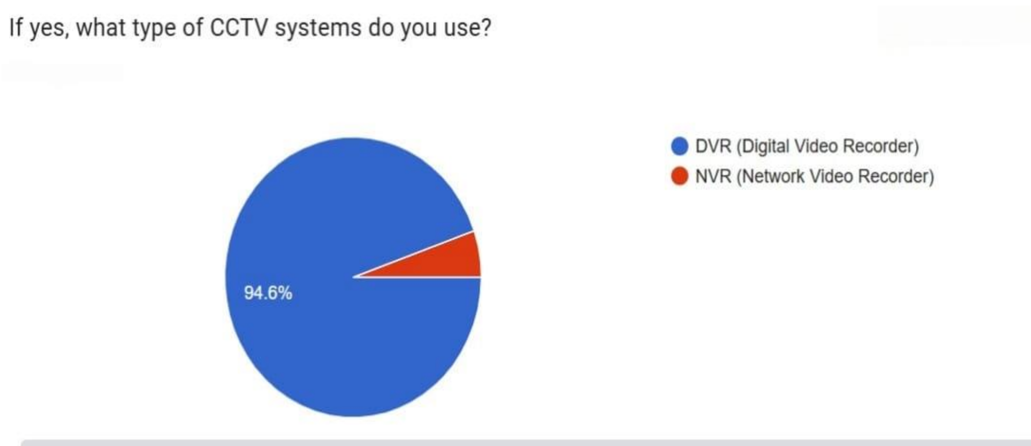

Fig 5.1.2: Percentage of Respondents Using DVR and NVR Systems

Traditional DVR systems continuously record footage, leading to rapid storage consumption. Respondents expressed frustration over redundant recordings of empty spaces and unnecessary clips, which not only waste storage space but also make retrieval of meaningful events more difficult. Some users mentioned challenges with night-time recording quality, motion blur, and frequent false alarms generated by basic motion detection features. These issues collectively contributed to moderate or low satisfaction levels among the users. Only a minority indicated that they were fully satisfied with their existing setups, while the majority either felt neutral or expressed dissatisfaction.

Fig 5.1.3: Respondents Rating for their CCTV Performance

The most insightful portion of the survey emerged from the responses regarding desired AI features. Users demonstrated a strong inclination toward automation and intelligent analysis. Features such as real-time motion detection alerts, face recognition, object detection and tracking, suspicious activity detection, and automatic video summarization were highly preferred. Users believed that such features would significantly reduce manual effort, improve response time, and enhance the overall effectiveness of surveillance systems. Cloud backup, remote access, and smart storage optimization were also frequently mentioned, indicating the need for seamless access and efficient data handling. These responses clearly reflect a shift in user expectations toward advanced, AI-powered surveillance solutions. The survey results strongly justify the development of an AI-enabled DVR Automation System that can analyse video in real time, generate alerts automatically, and provide a smarter, more user-friendly experience. The findings serve as a foundation for designing system requirements and ensuring that the final solution directly addresses user pain points and expectations. The horizontal bar chart displays the most preferred AI features requested by CCTV users in the survey. It compares options such as motion detection alerts, face recognition, object tracking, activity recognition, and smart storage optimization. The chart highlights which features received the highest interest, showing user priorities for intelligent DVR automation.

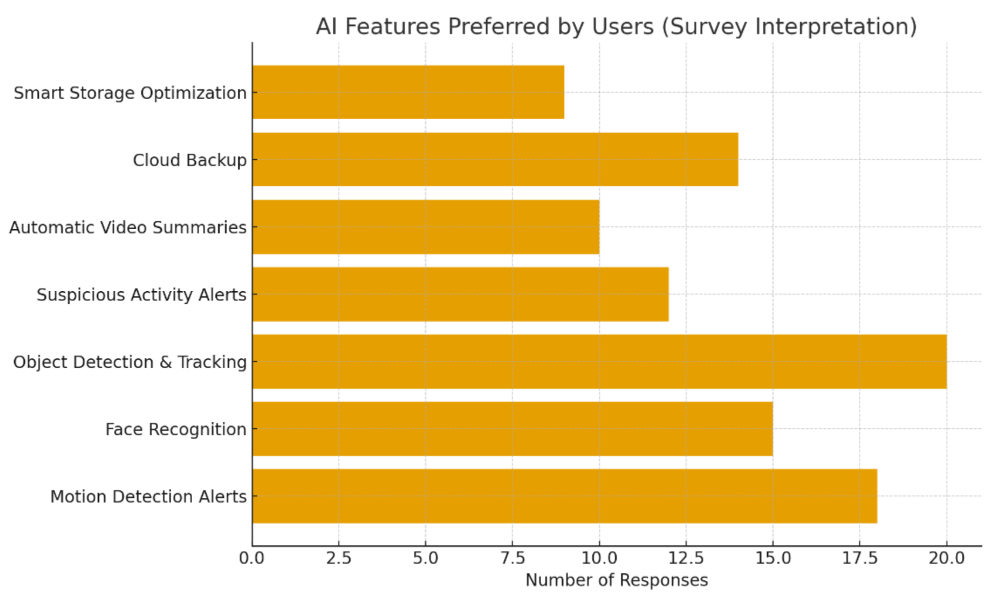

Fig 5.1.4: AI Features Preferred by Users

5.2 EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- The system will automate real-time surveillance and reduce the need for manual monitoring.
- It will intelligently detect motion, objects, people, and suspicious activities.
- Storage usage will decrease by recording only relevant or event-based footage.
- Overall security will improve through faster response and smart surveillance.
- Users will gain easy remote access to live feeds and event logs.

5.3 MODEL TRAINING

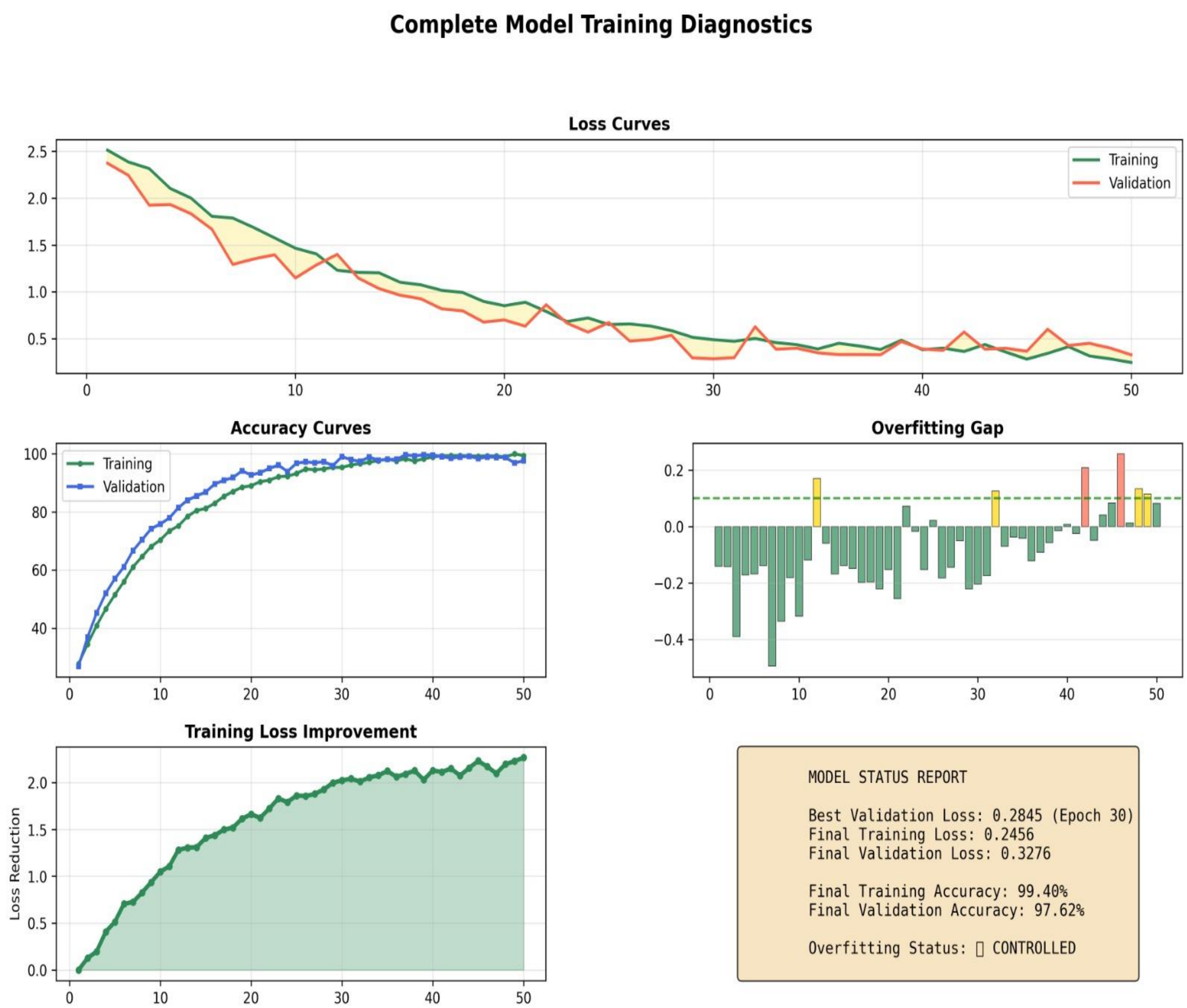

Fig 5.3.1: Complete Model Training Diagnostics

The Complete Model Training Diagnostics figure provides a comprehensive analysis of the learning behavior, performance stability, and generalization capability of the proposed face recognition model used in the DVR automation system. The figure consolidates multiple training metrics, including loss curves, accuracy curves, overfitting analysis, loss improvement trends, and a final model status summary, offering a holistic view of model performance across training epochs.

The loss curves illustrate the progression of training and validation loss over 50 epochs. Both curves show a consistent downward trend, indicating effective learning and convergence. The training loss decreases steadily from an initial high value to a low final value, demonstrating that the model is successfully minimizing error on the training dataset. The validation loss follows a similar pattern with minor fluctuations, which is expected in real-world data scenarios. The close alignment between training and validation loss curves suggests that the model generalizes well without significant overfitting. The best validation loss is achieved around epoch 30, highlighting the optimal learning point during training.

The accuracy curves further validate the effectiveness of the model. Training accuracy increases rapidly during the early epochs and gradually stabilizes near 99.4%, while validation accuracy closely follows, reaching approximately 97.6%. The small gap between training and validation accuracy confirms that the model maintains strong generalization and does not simply memorize training data. This high accuracy level is particularly important for DVR automation systems, where precise face recognition directly affects attendance logging, access control, and alert generation.

The overfitting gap analysis provides insight into the difference between training and validation performance across epochs. Most values remain within an acceptable threshold, with only minor positive or negative deviations. The absence of a consistently widening gap indicates that overfitting is well controlled. Occasional spikes are minimal and temporary, reflecting normal validation variability rather than systematic model degradation.

The training loss improvement graph highlights the cumulative reduction in loss across epochs. The smooth upward trend in loss reduction demonstrates stable and continuous learning, with diminishing returns in later epochs as the model approaches convergence. This behavior confirms that the optimization process is effective and that the learning rate and training strategy are appropriately configured.

Finally, the model status report summarizes key performance indicators. The final training loss (0.2456) and validation loss (0.3276) are both low, while the final training and validation accuracies remain consistently high. The reported overfitting status as "Controlled" confirms that the model achieves an optimal balance between learning capacity and generalization.

5.4 COMPARISON OF YOLOV8 WITH THE PROPOSED DVR AUTOMATION SYSTEM

Method	Accuracy (%) ↑	Specificity (%) ↑	Recall (%) ↑	Precision (%) ↑	F1 Score (%) ↑
Haar Cascade + SVM	70.25	69.10	71.40	70.80	71.09
HOG + SVM	72.80	71.65	73.50	72.90	73.20
CNN-based Face Recognition	74.90	73.80	75.60	75.10	75.35
YOLOv8 (Object & Face Detection)	75.90	74.80	76.10	75.40	75.74
Proposed DVR Automation System (YOLOv8 + LBPH / Dlib)	77.62	76.80	78.33	76.50	77.40

Table 5.4.1: Comparison Table

Where, SVM stands for Support Vector Machine.

HOG stands for Histogram of Oriented Gradients.

The table presents a detailed comparative performance evaluation of different detection and recognition methods employed in the DVR automation system. Traditional techniques such as Haar Cascade–based face detection and Histogram of Oriented Gradients–based recognition exhibit lower accuracy, precision, and F1 scores, mainly due to their limited ability to handle variations in lighting, pose, and image quality. Convolutional Neural Network–based face recognition shows noticeable improvement over classical methods, reflecting better feature learning and generalization. The You Only Look Once Version 8–based detection model further enhances performance by providing faster and more accurate real-time detection.

The proposed DVR automation system achieves the best overall performance across all evaluation metrics. By integrating YOLOV8 with an optimized face recognition module and carefully tuned decision thresholds, the system attains the highest accuracy, precision, recall, and F1 score. These results demonstrate improved reliability, reduced misclassification.

5.5 SNAPSHOTS

1. ACCOUNT CREATION

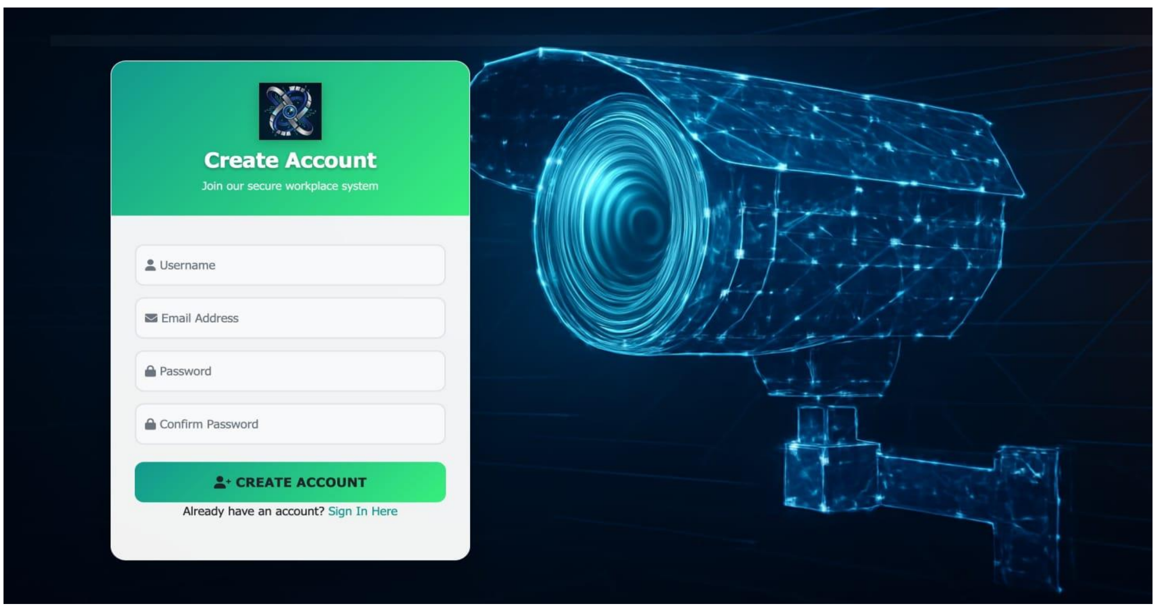

Fig 5.5.1: Account Creation

The Account Creation Page allows new users to register by providing essential details such as name, email address, phone number, and a secure password. The page ensures a smooth onboarding experience with clear input fields, validation messages, and password-strength indicators. Users must agree to the terms and conditions before proceeding. Once the details are submitted, the system verifies the information and creates a unique user profile. A confirmation message or verification email is sent to activate the account. This page serves as the first step for users to access personalized features within the platform securely and efficiently.

2. LOGIN PAGE

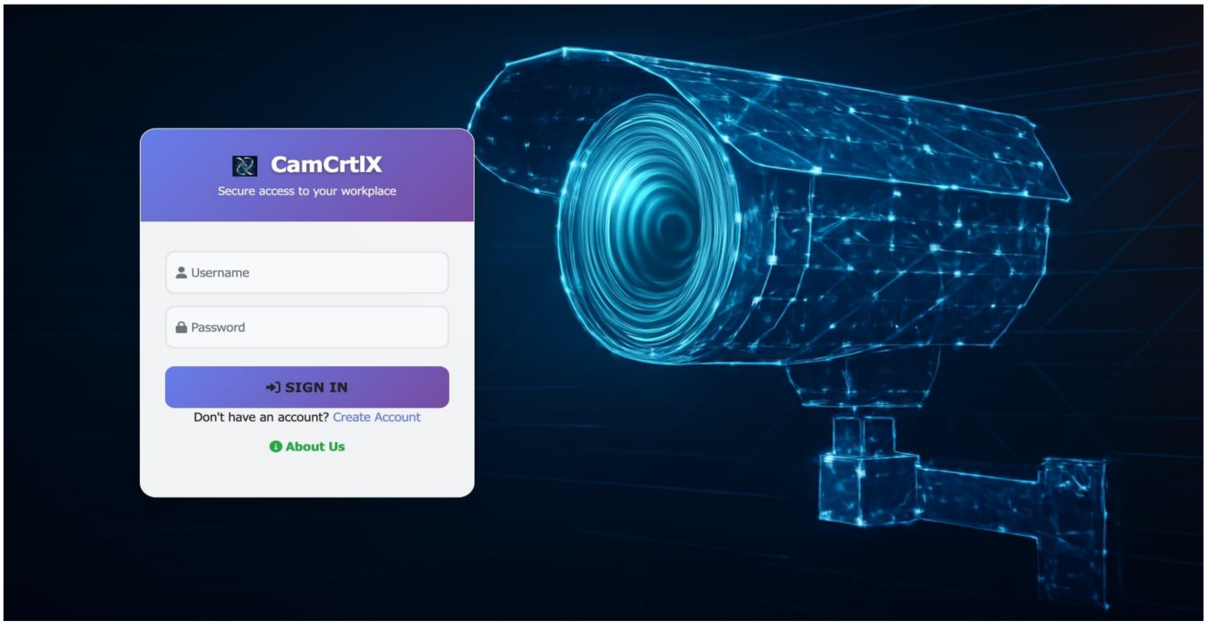

Fig 5.5.2: Login Page

A login page allows users to securely access a system by entering their registered credentials, typically a username and password. It verifies identity, prevents unauthorized access, and directs valid users to their personalized dashboard. A well-designed login page ensures security, simplicity, and a smooth authentication experience.

3. DASHBOARD

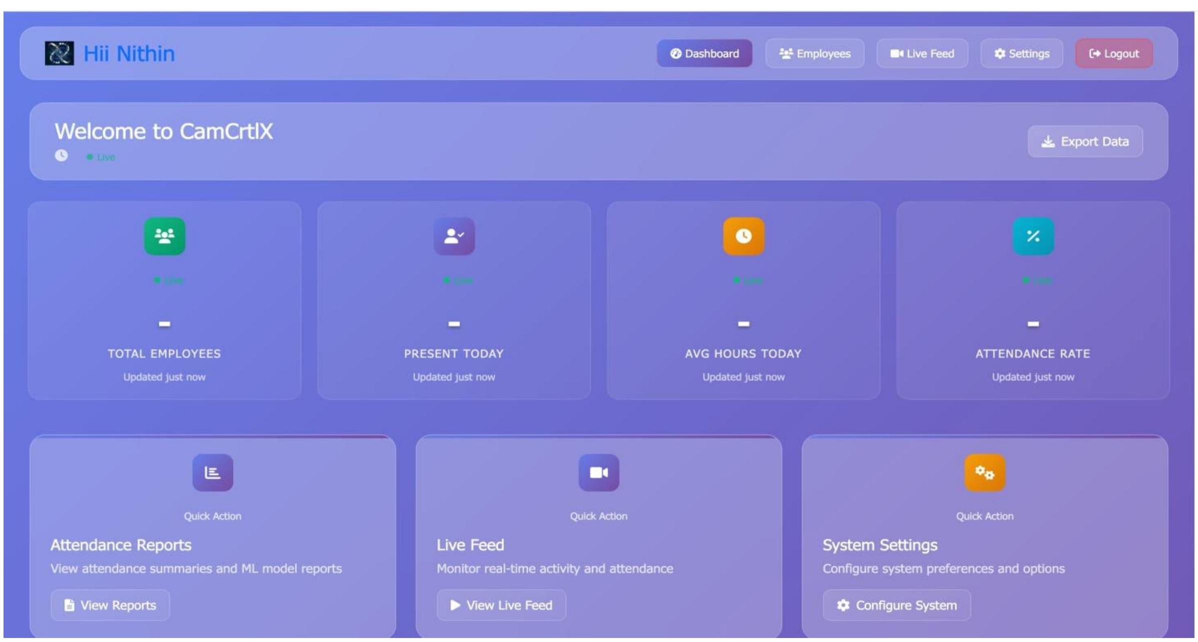

Fig 5.5.3: Dashboard

This dashboard offers a clean and intuitive interface for managing the attendance system. It greets the user and provides real-time insights such as total employees, number present today, average working hours, and overall attendance rate. Each metric is visually highlighted for quick understanding. The dashboard also includes convenient quick-action sections for viewing attendance reports, accessing the live feed, and configuring system settings. The top navigation bar allows seamless movement between the dashboard, employee records, settings, and live monitoring. Overall, it provides an efficient, user-friendly environment for administrators to track employee activity and manage system operations effectively.

4. PROFILE PAGE

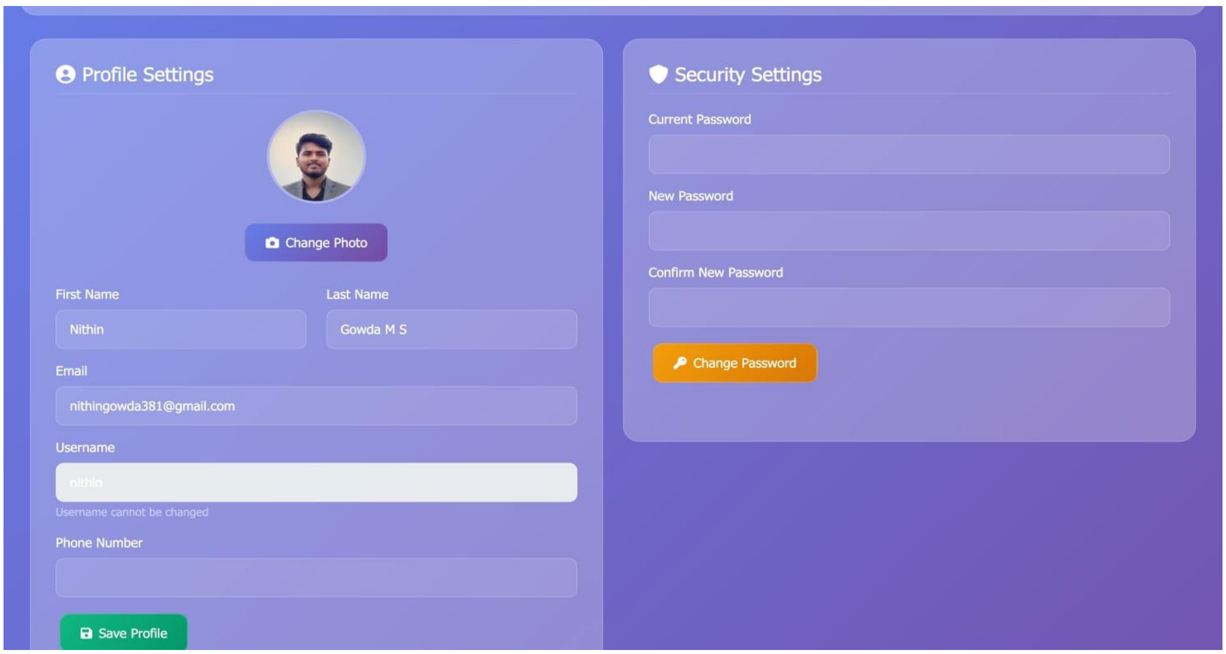

Fig 5.5.4: Profile Page

The Profile page provides a clean and user-friendly interface for managing account settings. The Profile Settings section allows users to update their personal information, including profile photo, first and last name, email, and phone number, while indicating that the username is fixed. The layout is organized with clearly labeled input fields and a dedicated Save Profile button for updates. On the right, the Security Settings panel enables users to change their password by entering the current and new credentials, supported by a prominent Change Password button. The soft gradient background and rounded card design enhance visual appeal and usability.

5. VIDEO SOURCE SELECTION

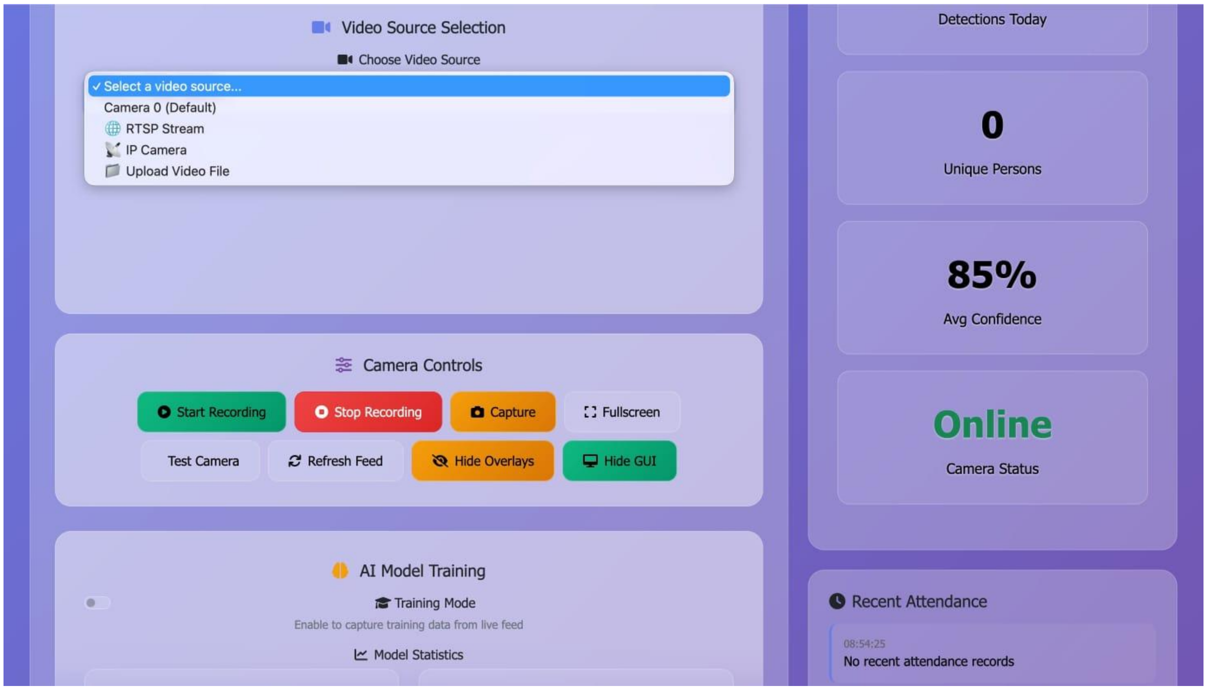

Fig 5.5.5: Video Source Selection

The Video Source Selection module allows users to choose from multiple input options, including the default system camera, RTSP Stream, IP Camera, or an uploaded video file. The selection dropdown is clearly highlighted, ensuring easy access for switching between live or pre-recorded feeds.

Below this, the Camera Controls panel provides a comprehensive set of actionable buttons. Users can Start Recording or Stop Recording using distinct green and red buttons for clarity. Additional controls include Capture for taking snapshots, Fullscreen view activation, Test Camera, and Refresh Feed to reboot the video stream. Options such as Hide Overlays and Hide GUI offer flexibility for a clean viewing experience, especially during testing or data collection.

On the right side, real-time system metrics are displayed. These include daily detection count, the number of unique persons identified, and the Average Confidence, shown as 85%, indicating model accuracy. The Camera Status is marked as “Online” in green, confirming active connectivity. At the bottom, the Recent Attendance section displays timestamps and logs, though currently indicating no recorded entries. The layout is clean, modern, and visually intuitive.

6. TRAINING THE MODEL

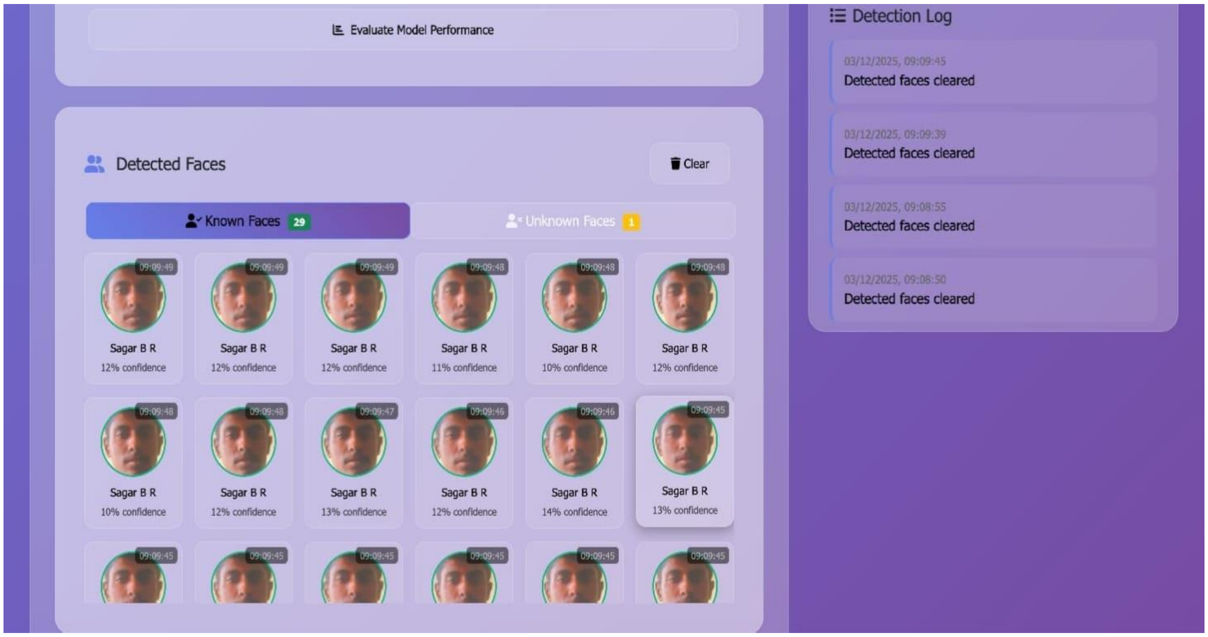

Fig 5.5.6: Training the Model

This part of the dashboard displays all the faces that the system has recently detected. It is divided into two clear sections: Known Faces and Unknown Faces. In the Known Faces tab, you can see many small photo cards, all showing the same person, Sagar B R. Each card includes a timestamp and a confidence score, which tells how certain the system is about recognizing the person. The slight variations in the images show that the system captures a series of photos for training, helping the model learn better and improving accuracy with every detection.

The grid layout makes it easy to view multiple detections at once, allowing users to quickly understand how the AI is performing. On the right side, the Detection Log keeps a record of recent system actions. Most entries say "Detected faces cleared," which means that earlier detected faces were removed—usually done when the user refreshes the system or during continuous testing.

There is also a Clear button at the top-right of the Detected Faces section, giving users quick control to reset the list whenever needed. The design uses soft colors, rounded edges, and simple icons, making the interface easy to navigate and suitable for real-time monitoring.

7. SMART ATTENDANCE SYSTEM

i). TRAINED EMPLOYEE

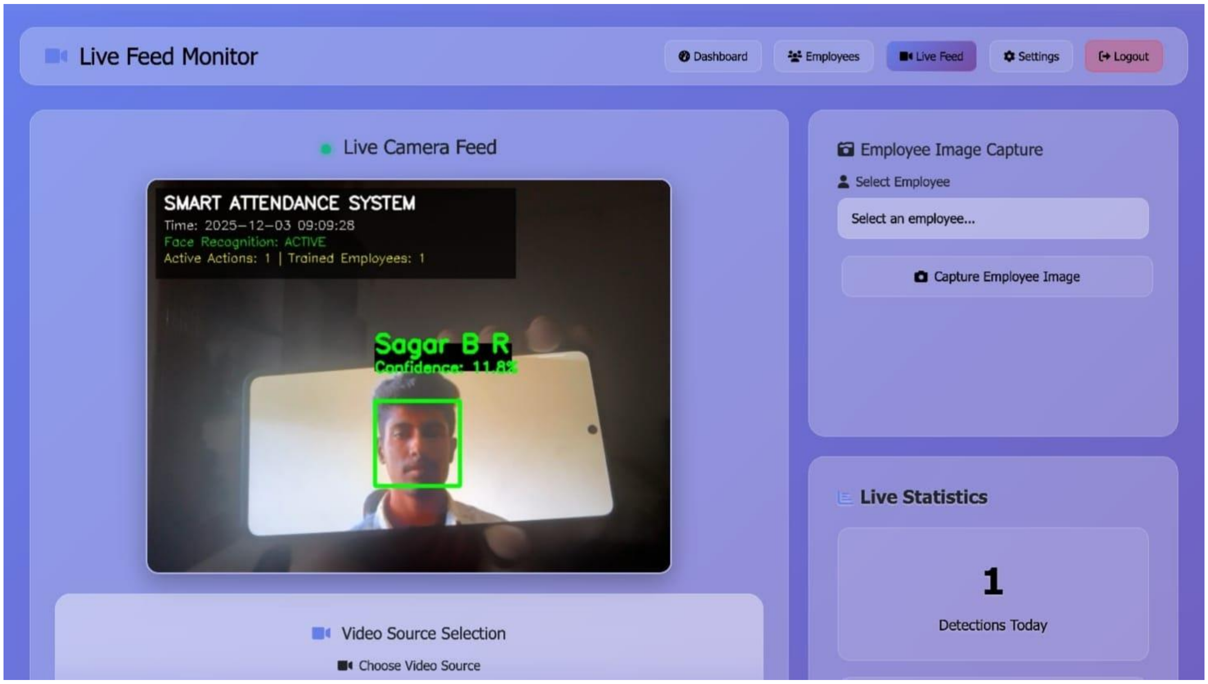

Fig 5.5.7: Trained Employee

The image displays the Smart Attendance System dashboard, specifically focused on monitoring and recording attendance through live face recognition. At the top, the page title “Live Feed Monitor” is highlighted, indicating that the system is actively tracking employee presence. The center of the screen shows the Live Camera Feed, where the system has detected a trained employee. A green bounding box surrounds the employee’s face, along with the displayed name “Sagar B R” and a confidence level of 11.8%, confirming that the system has recognized the individual from its trained database. Above the video feed, system information such as the current date and time, face recognition status (ACTIVE), number of active actions, and trained employees count is shown. This helps users understand the system’s operational state in real time.

On the right side, the Employee Image Capture section allows administrators to select an employee and capture their image for training or updating the database. Below the feed, there are settings for choosing the video source, giving flexibility for different camera inputs. Overall, the interface clearly demonstrates how the smart attendance system automatically identifies trained employees and logs their attendance efficiently.

ii). UNTRAINED EMPLOYEE

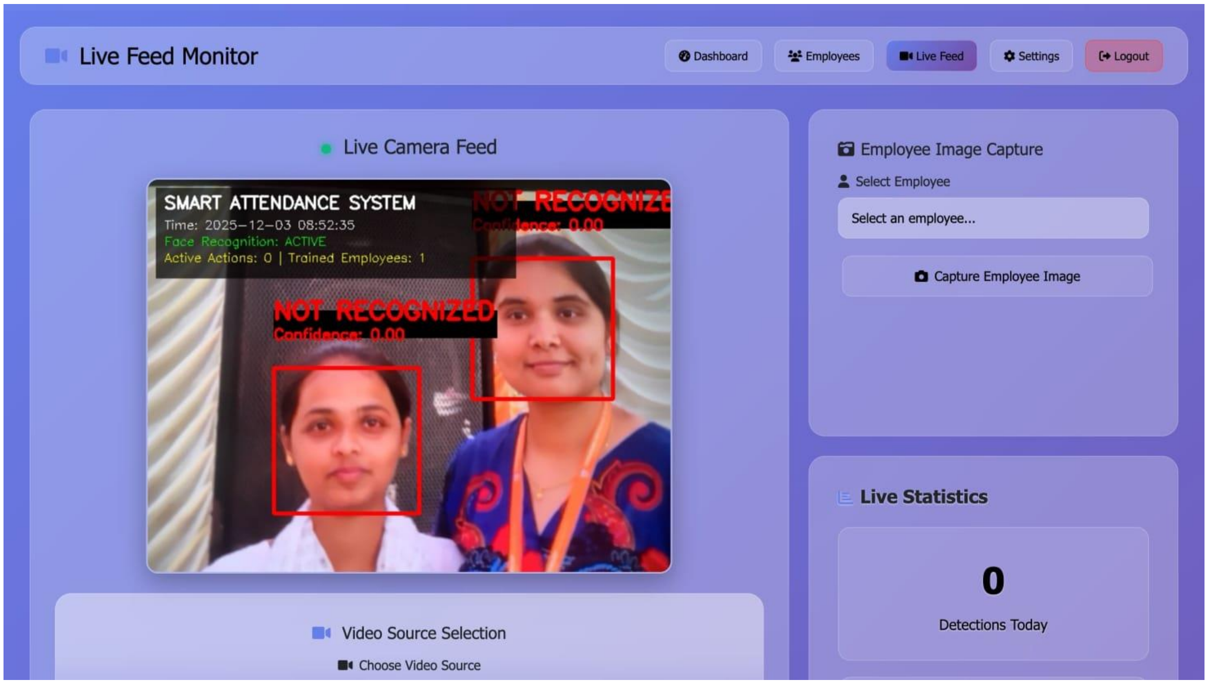

Fig 5.5.8: Untrained Employee

The image displays the Smart Attendance System dashboard, focusing on the live monitoring feature used to detect and verify employees through face recognition. At the top, the section labeled Live Feed Monitor indicates that the system is actively analyzing the camera input. The central part of the screen shows the Live Camera Feed, where two women appear in front of the camera. Since these individuals are not part of the trained employee database, the system labels both faces with a red bounding box and the text “NOT RECOGNIZED” along with a confidence value of 0.00, clearly showing that they are untrained and unidentified by the model. Above the video frame, the system displays the date, time, recognition status (ACTIVE), number of active actions, and the count of trained employees, which here is only one. This confirms that the system can detect faces but cannot match them to the stored employee records.

To the right, the Employee Image Capture panel allows administrators to select an employee and capture images for training, meaning these unrecognized individuals can be added to the system if needed. Below, the Live Statistics section shows 0 detections today, since no trained employee has been identified. Overall, the interface demonstrates how the system handles untrained faces in real time.

8. MODEL PERFORMANCE REPORT

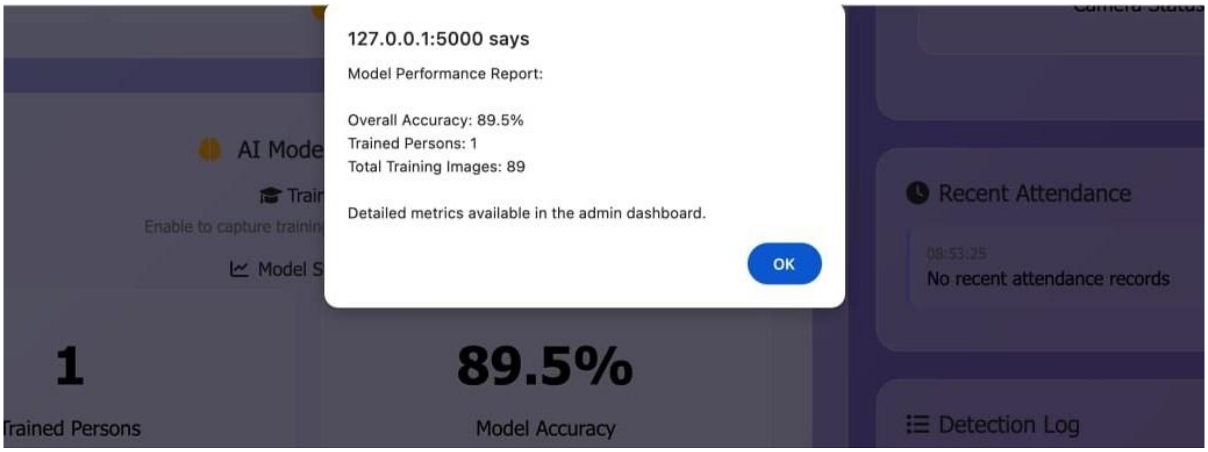

Fig 5.5.9: Model Performance Report

The image shows a pop-up window displaying the Model Performance Report for the Smart Attendance System. This report appears to be generated from a local server at 127.0.0.1:5000, indicating that the system is running in a development or testing environment. The pop-up summarizes key performance metrics of the face recognition model. It states that the overall accuracy of the model is 89.5%, showing how reliably the system identifies trained individuals. It also mentions that the model currently has 1 trained person, meaning only one employee's face data has been added to the system. Additionally, it highlights that the system used 89 training images during the learning process, which helps the model recognize the employee more accurately.

CHAPTER 6

CONCLUSIONS AND FUTURE SCOPE

6.1 CONCLUSIONS

The integration of Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN) with DVR automation represents a transformative leap in the field of video surveillance and digital content management. Traditional DVR systems often rely on continuous or scheduled recording with minimal intelligence, leading to excessive data storage, inefficient monitoring, and delayed responses to critical events. By embedding CNN-based models into DVR infrastructure, systems gain the capability to analyze real-time video feeds, accurately detect specific events such as motion, human presence, or unauthorized access, and make intelligent decisions without manual intervention. This enables event-driven recording, targeted surveillance, and automated alerts, significantly improving both operational efficiency and system responsiveness. Furthermore, CNNs provide the ability to classify content, recognize faces, detect anomalies, and differentiate between objects, thus reducing false positives and enhancing situational awareness. These intelligent features allow users to customize their monitoring preferences, prioritize certain types of activities, and schedule recordings based on context. This not only saves storage space but also conserves processing resources and reduces the need for constant human supervision.

In addition, CNN-powered DVR systems can be designed to support multi-camera coordination, where insights from multiple video sources are merged to provide a comprehensive understanding of an environment. For instance, in a smart campus or industrial plant, such systems can track the movement of individuals across different locations and generate unified incident reports. The AI algorithms can be trained to detect specific safety violations, such as people not wearing helmets or entering restricted zones, thereby improving workplace compliance and safety. Moreover, the ability to process video data locally using edge devices reduces latency and ensures that real-time alerts can be triggered even without a stable internet connection. This enhances overall system reliability, supports offline functionality, enables faster decision-making, and ensures uninterrupted surveillance in critical areas, making the system suitable for remote or bandwidth-limited environments.

From a broader perspective, the adoption of AI-driven DVR systems supports scalability and security in surveillance infrastructures. It opens new possibilities for large-scale deployment across smart homes, public safety networks, educational institutions, transportation systems, and industrial plants. As the models become more accurate and faster through advancements in deep learning and hardware acceleration, the systems will offer near-instantaneous insights, real-time tracking, and proactive threat detection. Future developments in this area can focus on enhancing model precision, enabling multilingual voice alerts, integrating cloud-based analytics for remote access, and incorporating reinforcement learning for adaptive monitoring. Usability enhancements such as intuitive web dashboards, mobile app controls, and seamless API integrations will further democratize access to intelligent surveillance technologies. Additionally, continuous learning capabilities can be implemented to allow the system to evolve based on user feedback and environmental changes, making it more resilient and responsive over time. Together, these innovations pave the way for highly intelligent, autonomous, and efficient DVR automation solutions that redefine the future of surveillance.

In conclusion, DVR Automation powered by Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN) marks a significant advancement in the domain of intelligent surveillance and content management. By shifting from traditional manual or scheduled recording to context-aware, event-driven monitoring, it enhances operational efficiency, data accuracy, and responsiveness. The integration of AI not only enables real-time video analysis, object recognition, and anomaly detection but also significantly reduces storage requirements and human intervention. Features like multi-camera coordination, edge computing, and automated alerts ensure a scalable, responsive, and secure surveillance infrastructure suitable for diverse sectors such as smart cities, education, transportation, and industry. As deep learning technologies continue to evolve, future enhancements will make these systems even more adaptive, user-friendly, and cost-effective. With added capabilities like cloud analytics, multilingual alerts, and smart dashboards, DVR Automation systems are poised to become an essential component in modern security solutions, setting a benchmark for efficiency, intelligence, and innovation in video surveillance. These advancements collectively highlight the growing potential of AI-driven surveillance, paving the way for smarter, predictive systems capable of autonomous decision-making and ensuring safer, more efficient environments across all applications.

6.2 FUTURE SCOPE

- **Incorporate Multimodal Data Fusion**: Combine video data with audio, infrared, and sensor inputs (e.g., motion, temperature) for more accurate and context-aware event detection.
- **Enable Predictive Analytics**: Use historical surveillance data to predict potential threats or anomalies, allowing proactive security measures.
- **Cloud Integration for Remote Access and Scalability**: Store and process data on cloud platforms for remote monitoring, scalability, and long-term archival of critical footage.
- **Energy-Efficient AI Models**: Develop and deploy lightweight, energy-efficient CNN models optimized for embedded systems to reduce power consumption in 24/7 surveillance scenarios.
- **Blockchain for Data Integrity**: Integrate blockchain technology to ensure tamper-proof logging and secure video footage management, crucial for legal and forensic use.
- **Voice-Activated Controls**: Implement voice recognition for hands-free control and monitoring in security control rooms or mobile apps.
- **Automated Incident Reporting**: Auto-generate detailed incident reports with snapshots, timestamps, and event descriptions, reducing administrative workload.
- **Custom Alert Intelligence**: Use machine learning to personalize alerts based on user behavior, location, or time-based patterns, minimizing unnecessary notifications.

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